

THE GREAT AWAKENING¹

Concepts and Techniques
for Successful Spiritual Practice

By

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This writing business.
Pencils and what-not.
Over-rated, if you ask me.
Silly stuff. Nothing in it.

Eeyore from Winnie the Pooh

Dedications

TO MY KIDS

If there ever comes a day
when we can't be together,
keep me in your heart,
I'll stay there forever.

Winnie the Pooh

TO THE WORLD

If you want to make a song more hummy,
add a few tiddely poms.

Winnie the Pooh

Table of Contents

Preface and a Note on Conventions.....	8
Part One: Road School.....	9
Connection.....	11
Connection/Awakening and not Enlightenment...	14
Getting Started.....	24
Spiritual Misconceptions.....	27
Misconception One: Your Soul is not Broken, but your Physical Unit Might Be.....	30
Misconception Two: Life's a Test.....	33
Misconception Three: Submit and Obey.....	38
Misconception Four: You are Being Punished.....	41
Misconception Five: What does not Kill You.....	45
Misconception Six: You Have to be Worthy.....	47
Visions of Reality.....	50
Breathing.....	60
Trust and Self Confidence.....	67
Ignition.....	84
Part Two: Driving the Roads of Creation.....	92
Steering.....	94

Road Safety.....	107
Roadside Communication.....	121
Synchronicity.....	128
Emotive Communication.....	133
“Sixth-Sense” Communications.....	139
Gender.....	146
Heresy.....	150
Nutrition, Exercise, and Rest.....	162
About the Author.....	177
References.....	178

Preface and a Note on Conventions

This book can stand on its own. However, this book is also part of an expanding system of spiritual thought and practice known as the **Lightning Path**. *The Lightning Path* contains many new concepts and many refined and redefined ideas that you can use to expand your thinking about spirituality, religion, mysticism, spiritual experience, and expand your consciousness.

In order to help orient you to the Lightning Path corpus, and in order to get you started thinking about and absorbing the ideas, Lightning Path concepts are highlighted in bold the first time they are introduced, after which the definition is provided. If you want to learn more about the definition, a footnote link takes you to the **SpiritWiki**² entry where an expanded definition of the concept is provided, along with links to related concepts, and references to LP books you can consult for additional information. If you want to learn more about a specific concept or idea, simply follow the links to the SpiritWiki and learn more about the concepts there.

²The SpiritWiki is the online glossary of Lightning Path thought. Visit <https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php>

If you like what you see here, feel free to visit the Lightning Path main website and Lightning Path Repository.

- <https://www.lightningpath.org/>
- <https://repo.lightningpath.org>

Part One: Road School

Connection

“What does Crustimoney Proseedcake mean?”
said Pooh. For I am a Bear of Very Little Brain,
and long words bother me. ~ **Winnie the Pooh**

Greetings and welcome. My name is Michael. This book is a spiritual primer and provides the foundational materials for connecting your **Spiritual Ego**³ with your **Bodily Ego**.⁴ As you learn in introductory Lightning Path materials, connecting your spiritual ego to your bodily ego is important. Connecting your spiritual ego to your bodily ego will lead not only to your awakening and activation (i.e., empowerment), but to the awakening and activation of the entire planet, what we might call the **Great Awakening**,⁵ or the individual and collective return of full Consciousness to this planet.

This book is a continuation of your introductory LP study. In this book, you will find information on the spiritual misconceptions you need to clear in order to be able to move forward, basic concepts you need to know to manage the introductory phases, as well as a reiteration of basic techniques, like breathing,

³https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Spiritual_Ego

⁴https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Bodily_Ego

⁵https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Spiritual_Ego

visualization, and intent, critical for progress forward into the new spiritual millennium.

I would like to say at the outset that no matter where you are on your spiritual path, this book will be useful. I would also like to say that although this book may seem simple and straightforward, there is a lot of information here. It is my strong advice that you not overlook the concepts and ideas presented here no matter how skilled or knowledgeable you might be. Just because this book functions as an introduction to basic spirituality does not mean it contains only simple information, or that the information here is optional. The materials presented are important. If you are going to make good progress on your return path back home, if you are going to wake up with speed and facility, you need to know the basics in some form or another. Learn the concepts here or learn them from someone else, it does not matter. Just learn them.

I would also like to say that although the information set forth here will be useful for all people interested in a rapid return to full Consciousness, this book will be particularly useful for those of you who have previous religious or scientific training, those of you who come

from judgmental spiritual backgrounds,⁶ and those who are experiencing *disorientation* or *anxiety* as a consequence of the chaos unfolding on this Earth. To you, I offer a special welcome. I promise you, you will find the material in this book will go a long way towards providing you calm and clear vision when it comes to your own efforts to sort through the things happening in your world.

Let me also say that neither this book nor any Lightning path books are books about classic notions of spiritual enlightenment. This is not a book about soul evolution, spiritual evolution, karmic work, “altitude,” clearing, or anything ridiculous like that. This is not a book about how to “save yourself” or others, and it is certainly not a book of commandments or morality. This is a book about connecting your spiritual ego with your bodily ego and the *awakening* that goes along with that. This is a book about empowering your body and mind with the full light of your glorious Highest Self and nothing more.

⁶That is, from all those belief systems that emphasize reward and punishment, karma, retribution, and other forms of soul-to-soul violence.

Connection/Awakening and not Enlightenment

Now, perhaps at this point you are curiously asking yourself, “Why connection and not enlightenment, salvation, or evolution as the priests or scientists might say?” It is for two reasons. On the one hand, it is because the notions of enlightenment, salvation, and evolution have too much baggage attached to them to be useful. When you get down to the nitty-gritty of it, there are centuries of dogma and misconception attached to the standard explanations of our origin and purpose. There are centuries of misdirection and lies about enlightenment, salvation, and evolution floating around in the collective consciousness of this planet. Many of these are simply misconceptions and bias, the result of the inadvertent imposition of invalid or self-interested “sets” and “frames” on spiritual gnosis. Some are the result of active repression of challenging truths, as when people refuse to think about things that would force them to change the way they act and behave. Still others are deliberate, economically motivated corruptions designed and distributed by **Ideological Institutions**⁷ specifically to confuse and

⁷**Ideological Institutions** are “special instruments of... thought control” designed to create a compliant population. See https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Ideological_Institution

misdirect.⁸ Because of all this, there is just too much rubbish attached to these concepts for them to be of any use at all.

The other reason why we do not want to use words like enlightenment, salvation, or evolution to describe this process is that despite all the millions of words creatively wasted on these concepts, the process discussed in this book (and in all Lightning path books), the process that happens when you begin to connect your spiritual ego with your bodily ego is more like awakening than anything else. It is not about enlightenment, karmic resolution, salvation, soul healing, evolution, testing, judgment, or any of the other nonsense you hear from the doomsayers, prophets, and self-styled messengers of this world. *The process is a process of awakening.* It is a process of returning your full Consciousness to your physical body and mind by connecting your spiritual ego to your bodily ego, and nothing more.

https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Ideological_Institution

⁸For one example see Mike Sosteric, "A Sociology of Tarot," Canadian Journal of Sociology 39.3 (2014).

To best understand, see the process of spiritual awakening as a continuation of your normal cycle of sleep and awakening.

Every day is the same.

Every cycle is the same.

Every night you go to sleep and “descend” into a state of reduced consciousness and reduced capacity. Your mind is numb, your senses are turned off, and your bodily systems respond only to emergency. However, every morning when you are rested, or when you, somebody you love, or somebody whom you asked to awaken you *brrriiiiiinnnnngggsss* an alarm clock close to your head, you wake up. You open your eyes, struggle back to “full” consciousness, and go about your daily work at “full” capacity with eyes “wide open” and consciousness “fully present” (or so you have been led to believe) with no trouble at all.

It is the same way with the spiritual awakening process that I am talking about, although for the sake of explanatory power we extend the metaphor a bit and shift our perception of the physical body. Thus, instead of identifying with your physical body as if it is a part of the “I” that is you, see your body/mind as a container for your Consciousness. View your body/mind as a

vehicle for your spiritual ego, a temple for your spirit. Know that it is a very good vehicle, an excellent vehicle in fact. Indeed, your body/mind combination is a finely tuned, precision-engineered powerhouse of creation.

However, despite its sophistication and power, *it is also a very fragile vehicle*. Not only must your body survive, revive, and regenerate from the daily insults of life on this Earth, it must also cope with the inferno of Consciousness that is your spiritual ego. To your body, which is crystallized, frozen energy, your soul is literally fire. The fire of your soul, which is necessary to animate your body, nevertheless strains the crystallized, ice-like molecular structures of your brain/body to the point of failure. Because of that, and because of the insults, toxins, and other physical challenges you endure during the day, every night your body and mind must rest to recover, regenerate, and repair.

Simple, right? In order to facilitate the regeneration of your body, your spiritual ego exits its mortal coil every night and goes cavorting out and about the multiverse. As a greater proportion of your animating soul leaves your body, your body goes to sleep. While sleeping, it repairs itself. When it is done its repair, spiritual ego comes back and your body wakes up.

Now, when sleeping, the body/mind (the physical unit) is *almost* empty of Consciousness. It cannot be fully empty because if it were, if your spiritual ego completely left your body, your body would immediately die. Thus, in order to preserve the physical integrity of the cellular structure of your body, your spiritual ego retains a thin connection to it.⁹ However, for the most part, when you sleep, Consciousness leaves the body alone so it can recover in peace.¹⁰ If you

⁹Some people call this connection your “astral cord,” but that image is really a metaphoric representation of a more complex relationship between soul and body. Technically, your spirit *envelops* the cells of your body; thus, when sleeping there is a diminished level of envelopment.

¹⁰Some of the dreaming that we do at night is a dim, heavily filtered, and often symbolically obscured echo of the activity of our spiritual consciousness as it goes out and cavorts in the multiverse. If you are interested, it is possible to improve the connection and remember more of what goes on. That is, it is possible to train your body/mind to keep a stronger connection to your soul. If you achieve this, your body/mind will remember (with greater or lesser clarity) where your soul has been and what it has been doing while your body sleeps and regenerates.

Many people, when they begin to go through their awakening process, do in fact begin to connect with the activities of their soul and do begin to remember what’s going on during the night. In the early, ungrounded stages, this can mean weird dreams and disturbed sleep patterns. In general, I do not recommend this and would actively discourage “night travels” of this type at any point in your awakening process. It is important that your body and brain be properly rested at all times. As you shall see, proper rest is even more important as you initiate and progress through the awakening

want a number, we could say two percent of your Consciousness, two percent of your spiritual ego, remains with your physical unit while it is sleeping. Of course, the percentage of Consciousness changes when you wake up in the morning. In the morning, when your body and mind are rested and recovered, your Consciousness returns more fully to your body. Not too much though. For reasons explained elsewhere,¹¹ but largely having to do with the **Toxic Socialization** process we all endure, under “normal” conditions only a fraction of your full Consciousness re-enters when you wake up, let’s say about thirty percent of your full Consciousness. This is not too much, and in reality represents a serious diminishment of your full capacity. This minimal percent makes the waking you, what society and psychologists would call the “normal” you, a mere shadow of who you really are. The fraction is enough for you to function “normally” (i.e., efficiently and without complaint) in the “normal” world, but it does not represent anywhere near your full human potential. In truth, it represents a sort of semi-conscious sleepwalking with semi-intelligence, semi-awareness. The truth is, “normal” isn’t very much of

process.

¹¹ *BOLIFE*

you at all. The truth is, there is a vast potential in you that lies unrealized and untapped.

If you want, you can consider the previous avatar Jesus Christ, or any of the other advanced spiritual luminaries of this planet, as exemplars of the possibilities open to a fully awakened, fully conscious human mind/body. It is exciting when you think about it.

As noted above, it is helpful to view your body as a container for your spiritual Consciousness. In fact, you can wrap your head around the whole awakening thing with greater ease (and even help others understand what you are talking about when you use words like *awakening*, *enlightenment*, or even *salvation*) if you simplify the container metaphor and strip it down to the bare essentials.

Do a visual experiment with me.

Visualize an empty water glass in your left hand and a clear glass jug of water in your right. Now, think of your body as the empty glass in your left hand and your Consciousness, your soul, as the water in the jug in your right hand. When you are conceived, (i.e. when sperm meets egg) you begin to pour water into the glass (i.e. the cells) to animate the body. After you are born,

and while you exist in **Normal Consciousness**,¹² you pour water into the glass to about the ten percent line. When you sleep, you pour water back out of the glass to about the two percent line. During your normal life cycles, you go back and forth between two percent and thirty percent, and that is the routine of everyday life. However, one day you decide to wake up in a spiritual sense. When you make that decision, you immediately begin to fill your glass beyond the thirty percent line to thirty-five percent, forty, and eventually even higher. This is the **Water Glass Metaphor**¹³ and this metaphor illustrates the spiritual awakening that occurs when you begin to connect your two egos.

Not enlightenment. Not evolution. Not transcendence. The expansion of Consciousness into the body. Awakening, pure and simple.

Now, getting a grounded understanding of the process of awakening is only the first step. Other questions need to be addressed such as, “Why are you sleepwalking through life” and, most important for this book, “How do you wake up and access full capacity?”

¹²https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Normal_Consciousness

¹³https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Water_Glass_Metaphor

The answers to why you are sleepwalking and how you access full capacity are provided elsewhere on the LP,¹⁴ but it basically comes down to the fact that it is easier to manipulate and enslave you when you are not completely awake, so I will not rehearse them here. As to how you wake up, it is not that hard at all. In fact, that is what this book is for. In these pages I will provide guidance on getting the awakening and activation process rolling. More importantly, I will show you that, contrary to what some might like to tell you, *the process of spiritual awakening is not that hard at all*. In fact, compared to what others might have told you, it takes only a little bit of time, willingness, and effort. How long it will take, and how much effort you will need to expend will depend largely on you and your own unique situation. Bottom line, some of you will find it easy to wake up and others will have more difficulty. However, do not misunderstand what I am saying here. Awakening is not a question of talent or worthiness or grace. It really just depends on the conditions in your life. However, even in the worst case, a few months is all you need to make significant progress forward. All you have to do is focus and

¹⁴If you want to find out more, read up on **The System** or view the associated videos.

<https://michael.lightningpath.org/the-system/>

practice. Focus on the path ahead and practice the techniques provided in this book every day.

It is not that hard at all, despite what you might have been told by others. What is even better, there is a nice bonus at the end of it all. Once you have finished this process you won't have any more need for psychologists, integral theorists, prophets, pundits, or any of the others whose job is to "save your soul," "fix you," or "improve you" in some way. As you will eventually come to realize, you are perfect already. All you have to do is connect your spiritual ego with your bodily ego, heal the body and mind, and wake up.

You just need to wake up.

You just need to wake up.

So wake up, and wake others up as well.

Embrace the *Great Awakening*.

It is going to be quite glorious and I promise you the world is going to change for the better, rapidly, in quite dramatic ways, despite what the doomsayers are saying, and despite any doubts you might have. To the unawakened, it is going to look like chaos (at first) and magic (a little later), especially as the process accelerates; but do not let the chaos scare you or the magic fool you. As you will learn from this and

subsequent Lightning Path books, the *Great Awakening* is a carefully orchestrated event that we (and by “we” I mean the seven billion people on this Earth) have been preparing for more than 100,000 years. In other words, it is no accident that you are here, so embrace it without hesitation and without reservation! Soon, there will be nothing left to fear.

Getting Started

If you are ready, then it is time to get started. We will begin, in the next chapter, by getting rid of some of the many misconceptions about spirituality that you may have absorbed while sleepwalking on this Earth (either in this life, or in previous lives). Once these misconceptions, these obstacles to your spiritual awakening, are out of the way, we will move onto a discussion of basic bodily techniques for safe awakening and activation. Through all of this remember, this is a basic book. None of the stuff we discuss here should be difficult to understand or disconcerting, and everything will be meted out in chunks that are easy to absorb and integrate.

As a final word before moving on, I certainly expect the information here to be of practical benefit to you. In fact, as you practice what I teach you should begin to

notice immediate changes, some subtle, some not so subtle, in your life and your state of consciousness. Pay attention to those changes, embrace them, welcome them with joy (because they mean a better life is on the way), and when they begin to accelerate, do not get freaked out. Some of the changes may feel dramatic and Earth shattering, at least on “that side” of the **meniscus**,¹⁵ but they are not. They only look that way. After a little bit of effort and progress, the changes you go through will not seem so very big at all.

However, if things are moving too fast, remember, you are in control of this process. You initiated the process by picking up this book and engaging in the practices outlined here, you can control the speed simply through intent, and you can stop the process altogether simply by putting the book down and forgetting. Feel free to do that if you need the break. Move as fast or as slow as you want—take breathers, take breaks. Take whatever time you need to integrate and process, and if

¹⁵Merriam-Webster Online defines meniscus as *the curved upper surface of a column of liquid*. The meniscus is the “skin” on the top of the water. It is the thick layer that the bugs float on beneath which extends the vast ocean. Here we use the term meniscus to describe the flimsy boundary between normal consciousness, and the divine Consciousness of higher reality. Pierce the boundary and you connect with higher levels, and even God. For more, see https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Meniscus_of_Consciousness

you need to, sleep a little longer. If you find this all too weird and discombobulating, and if there isn't anybody in immediate physical danger around you, feel free to hit the snooze button. We will manage just fine until you are ready. I will warn you though, *you can only hit the snooze button for so long. At some point, you have to wake up: just so you know, you cannot stay sleeping forever.*

Spiritual Misconceptions

"Yes," said Winnie-the-Pooh.

"I see now," said Winnie-the-Pooh.

"I have been Foolish and

Deluded," said he, "and I am a

*Bear of no Brain at All." ~ Winnie
the Pooh*

As I said in the last chapter, before we get into the practical advice and technique section of this book, I first want to clear the ground of any misconceptions you may have about what it means to be a spiritual person, and take a few steps towards establishing what I like to call, **Right Thought**.¹⁶ As I note in the SpiritWiki, right thought is thinking that supports the expansion of Consciousness into your physical unit. Put as bluntly as possible, *if your goal is spiritual awakening, then there is a right way to think about things and a wrong way.*

Of course, having said that, having admonished you to right thought, I realize that some resist the idea that any single person can make statements about right thought. If you do feel resistance, that's fine—do not

¹⁶https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Right_Thought

fret too much about it. You can doubt and ask questions as much as you like. I am not asking you to throw all your old ideas out and operate on blind faith. I am also not threatening you in any way. You are not going to burn in hell or be reborn as a slug for not establishing right thought. I am just asking you to try these ideas on for size for a bit and see if they do not lead you towards an obvious awakening and an easily recognizable expansion of consciousness. If you find these ideas are not leading you towards a positive spirituality and a positive empowerment, feel free to stick with what works (or does not work, as the case may be) for you. The door is always open and you can always come back and try again later.

However, I will say this. No matter what you do, it is important to understand (even at this early stage) that your ideas about spirituality determine your experience of spirituality and even your experience of life. That is, *your ideas have consequences. If you believe in a spirituality of judgment, damnation, competition, struggle, and strife, do not be surprised if you experience these things in your reality.* You (or more technically correct, we) create the world around you through the ideas that you have in your head. *If you*

*have **Old World**¹⁷ ideas and old world spiritual conceptions, you will create, live, and die in an old world of duality, conflict, and strife.* You can do that if you want; however, if you want to awaken from that old world nightmare and see what is really possible for an awakened and activated world, read on because this is the way forward.

With that said, I now want to offer for your consideration six major misconceptions of spirituality that interfere with right thinking, and some alternative ideas to replace them. I won't spend a lot of time on these, really just enough to note them and point you in the direction of alternatives. Beyond these notes, there is a lot of work, but the basic goal is simple: *clear these misconceptions and replace them with right thought.* If you do that, if you establish right thought in even the basic way outlined here, you will be well on your way towards experiencing an authentic spiritual awakening.

¹⁷**The old world** is the social, political, economic and psychological world of slavery, duality, war, profit, oppression, illusion, delusion and pathology that has been the reality of this world for many thousands of years.

https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Old_World.

Misconception One: Your Soul is not Broken, but your Physical Unit Might Be

The first misconception I want to deal with is the notion that your soul is broken and/or damaged in some way. This **Old Energy**¹⁸ idea has you believing that spirituality is a process of fixing your sorry, broken-down self. The reason your soul is broken and in need of fixing varies. Some people say it is because you ate some bad fruit and were thrown out of The Garden. Some people say that you are a bad little boy or girl and you do not listen to your Father's commandments. Some say you are full of sin and need to be constantly directed and punished. Some say you are souls in bodily evolution and you must struggle and compete through lifetimes of pain and despair in order to attain perfection of DNA. Some say you are apes—sinful, dirty, disgusting, un-evolved, and descended. Whatever they say I am sure you have heard it at some time before; but listen, none of these ideas is true. These are all false ideas designed to keep you struggling in the dark. If you want the truth, here it is:

¹⁸**Old Energy** is energy that is imbalanced, with a prevalence of forceful, violent, hierarchical, dominating, exclusionary, elitist, and in the most extreme cases, psychopathic qualities. Old energy is generated by **Old Energy Archetypes**.

https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Old_Energy

The truth is, you are not descended from apes; you are not souls in training; you are not evolving from mud; you are not broken angels; you are not weak and sinful; you are not cast-outs from The Garden. The truth is, you are not broken in any way and you are certainly not in any need of salvation. The truth is, you and everyone on this planet are on a mission. The truth is, we have undertaken a Divine task, a **Great Work**.¹⁹ In order to accomplish this work, we have had, for generations, to walk around in “darkness” with a blindfold²⁰ placed over our minds. This blindfold has prevented, up until now, our full spiritual Consciousness from entering the physical body. In other words, we have been asleep, but for a reason!

Now, you do not need me to tell you, it has been a tough slog. We have had to put up with a lot of nonsense and abuse while sleeping through our

¹⁹**The Great Work** (a.k.a. Evolution) is the collective work of creating playground paradises for the enjoyment of all.

See https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Great_Work/

²⁰**The Allegory of the Blindfold** is an allegorical treatment of the process of spiritual The allegory highlights, in metaphorical form, the traps, pitfalls, difficulties, and triumphs associated with the process of spiritual awakening.

See

https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Allegory_of_the_Blindfold

mission. I would be the first to acknowledge, we have endured pain and suffering and this pain and suffering has damaged us and that, as a consequence, we all need some form of psychological, emotional, and spiritual healing to heal the physical unit of damage the prevents connection and awakening. The point here though is not to go into detail about the **Sacrifice**²¹ we have made or the healing that is now required; the point is to point out that our old energy ideas of what it involves to be spiritual are wrong. *Spirituality is not about fixing what is broken; spirituality is about filling the cup of the body with the water of Consciousness.* Spirituality is about connecting your spiritual ego with your bodily ego.

It is important you get this right. *If you accept old energy notions that we are broken and need redemption, then you will waste your time trying to fix what is not broken.* If you reject those ideas and instead embrace your physical vehicle as a container for higher Consciousness, then you can focus your attention on healing the vehicle and making it a proper and functioning vessel for your spiritual ego. One set of ideas wastes your time by leading you to impotent

²¹“Sacrifice” in a key LP idea or archetype. This archetype represents the sacrifice we all make in order to incarnate on an evolving planet like Earth. For more, see

https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Sacrifice_Archetype

attempts to fix what is not broken; the other side moves you forward by encouraging you to focus your attention and energy on creating conducive conditions for the descent of Consciousness. The difference in conceptualization is profound and it can make all the difference in the world to your efforts to awaken and activate.

Misconception Two: Life's a Test

The second misconception I want to deal with is the “life is a test” misconception. In this misconception, spirituality is seen as one big test. In this view, you have to work hard, do your homework, polish your shoes, clear your karma, learn, evolve, hope, and pray that when the time comes for judgment you will “pass the test” and be found worthy, strong, intelligent, good, and/or genetically fit. In this individualized and solipsistic view, life is about working and improving yourself so you can build/be a better soul.

Once again, I am sure you have heard this all before; and once again, I am here to tell you it is a bunch of spiritual hooey. The truth is, your life is not a classroom, this Earth is not a school, and your goal is not to expose yourself to judgment in the hopes of passing some kind of cosmic final exam. The truth is,

you are not on this Earth to prove your worthiness or win your way back into God's good graces. The truth is, you are not here to learn to be good little boys and girls. Spirit exists forever and when you die you are not judged, stamped, and sent to the "appropriate karmic level." There is no entrance fee, no judgment at the door, no pearly gates, no gatekeeper, no test of worthiness, no complicated curriculum, no final exam, and no nothing. It does not even matter what you have done in this or any past life. The truth is, your soul could be black as coal and you would still get to wake up and walk back into **The Garden**²² for a nice cup of tea, just like that, no questions asked and no strings attached.

When you die, all that happens is that you take another body (or not, depending on what you want to do) and are reborn into a situation of your choosing.

It is important you understand this, so pay attention. Nobody makes you take a body. Nobody tells you where to incarnate. Nobody sets a plan for you. Nobody (except you) judges your sins. Finally, nobody (not even God) tells you where to go, what lessons to learn, or what you should experience. As Immortal Spirit, whatever you want to do, wherever you want to go,

²²https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/The_Garden.

whatever you want to experience, and whomever you want to be, is your choice. In other words, whatever makes you happy!²³ There are no judgments attached to your performance and no strings attached to your existence. It is all up to you and it is all within your power. Make the choices that are right for you and the ones you love,²⁴ and do not worry about cosmic tests or karmic retribution because they do not exist.

Of course, if you accept this, if you accept that we choose to incarnate on this Earth simply to live and be happy, then the next question becomes *why do so many of us experience poverty, starvation, hunger, and horrible living conditions?* If we choose to come here, then do we not also choose to die of starvation, live life in a shantytown, or experience physical and emotional abuse? The answer to that is an unequivocal no. We do choose to incarnate on this planet but we do not choose to suffer in the horrible ways we are made to suffer.

If that is true, then how do you explain all the suffering, and the apparently contradictory fact that we choose, but do not choose? There are a couple of things you need to know if you are going to resolve this contradiction. **First**, you have to understand that when

²³Just do not hurt others.

²⁴Just do not hurt others.

a new body is created (i.e. when two people have sex and create a child) Consciousness must enter else the body is still-born. In other words, no matter how bad the conditions are, somebody has to volunteer to bring the light of Consciousness to the situation. That is just the way it is. When a body is made available, Consciousness must enter. *This is true even in cases where the spiritual ego knows that the situation it is incarnating into is characterized by violence, sexual abuse, poverty, and war*, and even when they know they will exist in a blindfolded state. Even in these situations, some monad must volunteer and enter. This does not mean that the monad has to be happy about it, or accepting of it, or that they can be said to choose the bad conditions, or that we, as a species, should not do something about it. It just means somebody has to fill the empty body; therefore, a monad must enter. But, the individual monad does not choose the bad conditions. The bad conditions exist because of our toxic social, political, and economic systems. Given a proper choice, monads would never choose to incarnate into conditions such as exist on this Earth, ever. They do it only because it has to be done.

Second, you have to realize *the conditions that cause poverty, hunger, violence, war, and all the other unnecessary suffering that goes on, on this planet, are*

imposed on us. That is, suffering is not caused by God and it is not a feature of evolutionary design; suffering is forced on us by a political and economic system (what I call **The System**²⁵) designed to privilege the few while the many suffer and die in imposed silence. There is nothing natural, inevitable, or salutatory about these conditions.

To ask why we choose to live in these situations is really to ask (and attempt to answer) the wrong question. The real question is not why we choose these conditions. The real question is, “Why, given our awesome power and divinity, do we allow the world to exist as it is?” Why, in a world of economic and technological plenty, do so many people suffer and die in silence? The short answer to that question is we need to be blindfolded in order to complete Stage Five of the Great Work.²⁶ The longer answer is beyond the scope of this work. For now, just understand, Stage Five is

²⁵The System (a.k.a. the **Regime of Accumulation**) is a political/economic system designed specifically so that a minority of privileged people can accumulate wealth and power from a suppressed and exploited majority.

https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/The_System

²⁶The Great Work, which is the work of evolving a playground for Spirit, passes through seven stages.

See

https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Evolutionary_Stages

complete and we need to move onto Stage Six, which is the healing and reconnection phase. In this penultimate stage of this planet's evolutionary process, we will need to put aside erroneous ideas that this Earth is some kind of testing ground or school house where we come to learn lessons and prove our worth. Instead, we will all need to reconnect, awaken, and empower so that we can address the violence, inequality, greed, and exploitation so that the planet can heal, reconnect, and finally enter **Stage Seven** which is **Graduation**.

Misconception Three: Submit and Obey

The third misconception I want to deal with in this chapter is the notion that spirituality is about submission and obedience. According to this misconceived notion, you are supposed to submit to God's commandments, cosmic laws, and divine plans, or else. According to this notion, you are the submissive subject on which greater powers act. In this view, God is authority and you are its subject. Accept and submit. If you do not, you will be punished. Bow low and be humble little lambs. Do what you are told or Santa will bring you coal. Do what you are told or St. Peter won't let you in through the Pearly Gates. Do not rebel or you will be cast out. Do not sin against God (i.e. against

authority) or you will be damned to eternal hell fire. Bow low before the **Hierophant**;²⁷ only then will you be initiated into the great mysteries.

To all this I have only one thing to say and that is rubbish. The truth is, God is not an authority figure and spirituality is not about obedience. The truth is, doing what you are told does not make you a spiritual person, a good person, or a holy person. Doing what you are told also does not make you a bad person either. Doing what you are told just makes you a person who does what they are told to do—that is all. It goes no deeper than that. Do not expect divine karmic reward or punishment for following, or not following, authority.

That said, you just cannot run around doing whatever you want. Thoughts, choices, and actions have consequences for you and others; being spiritual means you are aware of those consequences. Being spiritual means taking responsibility for your actions. Make good choices and engage in **Right Thought** and **Right Action**²⁸ and these will contribute to awakening and re-connection. Make bad choices, make choices that

²⁷<https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Hierophant>

²⁸**Right Action** is action/behaviour that supports Healing and Connection.

See https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Right_Action

poison your mind and injure your (or somebody else's) body, and you are making it harder on yourself.

It is your choice but remember, as explained in *Lightning Path Workbook Three*, not only do you live with your choices, you are also expected to clean up (i.e. atone) your own messes. If you want to go jump around in the mud, be prepared to do your own cleanup work. If you get drunk, get behind the wheel, and kill somebody, be prepared for some serious consequences. If you hurt your spouse, damage your children, exploit some workers, or drop a bomb, you will need to make it right. If you want my advice, you want to avoid making messes and mucking around with others' lives because you are responsible for the messes you create. If you make a mess, you have to clean it up. That is what is traditionally understood **karma**, and you cannot get away from that, especially as you reconnect and wake up. Indeed, the more you awaken, the more you will feel pressure to atone. You can save yourself a lot of future struggle if you start making the right choices and stop making messes immediately.

Misconception Four: You are Being Punished

The fourth misconception about being spiritual that I want to deal with in this book is the notion that

punishment is involved. In this view, being spiritual means being subjected to karma, judgment, damnation, and retribution. There are consequences for failure, and for not following the rules. If you mess up, you are going to have to pay. If you screw up, you will go to jail (a.k.a. Hell). You'll be put into a work camp. You'll go to purgatory. You'll be karmically reborn as a slug or maybe (as I heard one Catholic priest say on television once), your soul will be snuffed out and your naughty little existence terminated like the worthless piece of cosmic turd that you are. The bottom line of this misconception is simple: if you do something wrong, You are going to be punished.

To all the above all I can say is, bull shit. The truth is, there is no such thing as hell or purgatory, God is not standing in judgment, Satan will not be your jail keeper in hell, universal karma ain't going to get ya, and nobody (at least nobody breathing with Spirit) is going to punish you or otherwise make your immortal existence painful in any way, no matter what you have done. There is no gatekeeper at the Pearly gates. St. Nick is not keeping a list, he's not checking it twice, and he certainly doesn't care whether you have been naughty or nice. These ideas are senseless and without

merit.²⁹ The truth is, your worst enemy, the person you hate the most, the person who has done you wrong a million times through 10,000 lifetimes retains, even now, even after death, has exactly the same rights and privileges as you do. As much as you might want to believe that someone like Hitler is burning in Hell, or has been reborn into a lower karmic birth, or is being punished or excluded by God in some way, he ain't. It just does not work that way. It simply does not matter what kind of "justice" you think exists in the universe; cosmic punishment, cosmic incarceration, even when euphemized as karma, does not happen. We all retain exactly the same rights, privileges, and entitlements no

²⁹There is no point in commenting on the whole "burn in hell" thing. The silliness of that becomes obvious once you realize a) the nature of Consciousness (which as noted in my Book of Light is awareness, love, and compassion) and b) the fundamental oneness of all Creation. We are all part of the same Fabric of Consciousness. Burning somebody in hell for sin would be a lot like sticking your own hand into an open flame and leaving it there. It really makes no sense at all.

The whole idea of karma is ridiculous as well. Karma is based on a vengeful perspective and leads to collective self-mutilation. It is cosmic nonsense that sets up hyper-destructive "karmic loop." I kill you; I got karma. Somebody kills me; they got karma. Somebody kills them; that person gets karma, and so on, and so on, and so on. If karma really exists, then we all exist in an endless karmic punishment loop that inevitably spirals into chaos and mutual destruction. If you ask me, the whole idea is just fucking stupid.

matter who we are, what we have done, or where we have been.

Now, if the thought of this makes you angry, tough. Hatred and anger, the desire for vengeance, the need to see somebody else in pain just because you are in pain, these are the nightmares of a sleeping body and they do not belong in a fully awakened existence. In fact, the two are mutually exclusive. Your spiritual Consciousness is all about love, inclusion, expansiveness, and giving. *Your higher self is a glorious beacon of light and love and it cannot abide the negativity of this world.* The truth is, your higher self cannot get close to all the negative nonsense you keep percolating in your noodle. If it does, it burns. If your mind is full of hate, judgment, hierarchy, and suffering, you will not be able to wake up because your Consciousness will not be able to enter. Harboring this sort of negativity is “anti-consciousness.”³⁰ Your higher self would simply be in too much pain and as a result, it will stay away. Sorry to say, but that’s just the way it is. As long as the Jews hate the Arabs, the Arabs hate the Americans, the Americans hate al Qaeda, and we all have hate each other, nobody is waking up

³⁰If you think of high levels of consciousness in the body as having Christ Consciousness, then things that are anti-consciousness can be seen as anti-Christ Consciousness, or just anti-Christ!

because it is simply impossible. If you want my advice, let go of hatred, anger, vengeance, judgment, and ideas about wrath and damnation and let the healing begin so that Consciousness may enter and bloom.

Before closing this section I should say, “letting go” of anger, hatred, and vengeance does not necessarily mean forgiving (at least in the way that most people think of forgiving), and it certainly does not mean accepting or enabling. You might let go of the anger and hatred you feel towards a pedophile, a drunk driver, or an exploiting politician, but this does not mean you let them back into your space, let them off the hook, or let them continue in their violent and negative ways. If you do that, not only are you part of the problem, but you will experience painful and unresolvable emotional and psychological **disjuncture**³¹ as well. Instead, and for reasons outlined in *Lightning Path Workbook Four*,³² you have to hold people accountable. This does not mean harm them. This means making them take responsibility. This means making them atone for their

³¹**Disjuncture** is an emotional state of unease, disquiet, and discomfort caused when an individual engages in Wrong Thought and Wrong Action, or that lives within/creates Wrong Environments that are not in Alignment with Highest Self. In the most serious cases of misalignment, intense feelings of guilt and shame can ensue. <https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Disjuncture>

³²See <https://www.lightningpath.org> for LP Workbooks.

actions. That is the only way forward for them, for you, and for this planet.

Misconception Five: What does not Kill You...

The fifth misconception that I want to deal with in this book is the “what does not kill you makes you stronger” misconception. This misconception suggests that we should accept all the bad things in life because they aren’t bad, but good for you. According to this idea, it is the bad things in life that “make us who we are.” What does not kill you makes you stronger! After all, you are a diamond in the rough—a soul in training. You are being tempered in the fires of creation and bad things are part of God’s lesson plan. Do not question the violence, suffering, and abuse; simply accept what comes your way as an essential part of the divine, cosmic plan.

Now, I’ve said it before and I’ll say it again, it is nonsense. The truth is, God and Spirit are magnanimous, loving, and expansive. The truth is, there is nothing in any spiritual contract or cosmic document that requires you to put up with violence, abuse, assault, poverty, exploitation, or the malfeasance and greed of others. There is nothing particularly spiritual about standing by while another abuses or exploits you.

God does not want that, your higher self does not require that, and it is not even necessary in the context of the Great Work. The truth is, violence and abuse, trauma, pain and suffering *damage* your physical unit and make it harder to connect. The more damage, the harder it is to connect. Therefore, if you find you are exposed to abuse, I recommend you take steps to stop it. Exercise your God-given right to put your foot down and say, no more! Compromise in a healthy and mutually respectful relationship is one thing, but nobody, especially God, requires you to suffer in the interests of some ridiculous “lesson” plan. Like any psychologically healthy and loving parent, God would rather see you joyful, healthy, and alive than in any kind of pain, prison, or purgatory. My advice to you is *quit making excuses for the suffering that you experience*. Stand up and end the violence and abuse.

Enough, as they say, is enough.

Misconception Six: You Have to be Worthy

The sixth and final misconception I want to deal with is the protestant notion that being smart, rich, famous, accomplished, or powerful has anything to do with spirituality or spiritual advancement. In this view, being spiritual is a question of being worthy. Either you are

born worthy (i.e. you are chosen) or you have to earn it (become successful). In this view, it is about purification, evolution, alchemical transformation, or deep spiritual gnosis made available only to the chosen ones. In this view, it is about how easily you get into a lotus position, how many mushrooms you eat, how well you understand integral philosophy, how many books you have read, and so on. In this view, spirituality has something to do with how hard you work, how far you get, and how high you climb that funny little ladder.

Once again, all I have to say is, twaddle. Being spiritual has nothing to do with any of the things mentioned above. It has nothing to do with how smart you are, how rich you are, how much you attain, how hard you work, or how much you achieve. It is not about worthiness, utility, or usefulness. It is not about purification, evolution, alchemical transformation, or deep spiritual gnosis. You do not have to attain an egoless state, you do not have to scrunch into lotus position, you do not have to quiet your thoughts into nothingness, you do not have to understand integral philosophy, and you certainly do not have to struggle with the lunacy of Enochian magic. That stuff is mere distraction at best—superficial window dressing—the veneer of a lost and confused bodily ego pretending that it knows when in reality it does not. The truth is,

you will do much better, and make faster progress, if you avoid that stuff altogether.

So, if spirituality is not about accepting your broken nature, if it is not a test, if it is not about submission to authority, the working out of karma, the acceptance of bad things, or the outward manifestations of power, intelligence, wisdom, evolution, or transcendence, then what is it? Well, I have already told you. *Spirituality is all about filling the glass (i.e. your physical body) with the water of consciousness.* It is all about expanding the light of your divinity into the dark recesses of your body and brain. It is all about connection. More to the point, being spiritual is about:

- a) Doing what it takes to prepare the vessel so that it can incorporate, accommodate, and ground Consciousness as it descends into the vessel and
- b) Initiating and encouraging the descent of Consciousness into the vessel, when you think you are ready to do that.

Prepare the vessel and pour the water.

Prepare the vessel and pour the water.

That is all there is to being a spiritual person. That is all there is to spiritual advancement. That is all there is to making a connection and ascending into union.

Of course, saying those two things is a long way from actually accomplishing these two things. It is very easy to specify the process in general terms, but the real work begins when you get into the details, and that is what we will do with the rest of this book, starting with advice on the importance of breathing,

Visions of Reality

*Before beginning a Hunt, it is
wise to ask someone what you are
looking for before you begin
looking for it. ~ Winnie the Pooh*

I hope that after reading the last chapter you have taken into consideration some of the things I have said and are ready to begin “preparing the vessel.” If so, great. We’ll get to some basic techniques that can help you get the process started in the next section. However first I want to talk a little about about the nature of reality, about the purpose of our existence on this planet. Why are we here? What is this all for? What the fuck is going on.

We all ask these question, right? And, we all search for answers until we find a satisfactory one. Most people pick one of two answers. Either we conclude a) that this is all some kind of spiritual test (the religious version) or b) that it is the senseless result of a random, violent evolution (the scientific version). Personally, when I was a child I picked the first one, but when I went to university I picked the second.

For a long time I naively thought there was a big difference between these two versions of reality. How can you equate creation by God with random evolution after all? However, after struggling with both versions for a long time I eventually realized the truth, which was that there no difference between the two. You can see the truth of this when you overlook the superficial differences and take a deeper look at the similarities in the versions.

Both versions are hierarchical, for example. Both versions say that some people are chosen, and some are not. Both versions say that some of us are stronger/better/more worthy, while others are weak/pathetic evolutionary losers.

Both versions are also exclusionary. Both say that the chosen, the better, the stronger deserve more. The chosen get to enter special clubs (like Heaven, or Club 33, or whatever), rise to the top, and take home all the winnings while the losers get what they deserve.

Finally, both versions accept and justify suffering and inequality by presenting the world “as it is” as proper and good. On the religion side, the world is as it is so you can learn and redeem yourself. You are filled with sin, you have karma, to pay, you are fallen souls and the world is the way it is so you can pay your debt and

redeem yourself. On the science side, the world is as it is because of nature, because of a violent and competitive struggle for survival where some rise to the top and the rest are trampled below. You are poor, you struggle, you die not because of the twisted social, economic, or political system you live in but because you are weak and undeserving. The strong dominate and thrive; the weak suffer and die. It is part of the natural order of things and because of that, you should just accept the status quo and move on with your life.

When you put the two stories together and show their similarities, you may realize, as I did, that both versions are the same story. Both versions provide justifications for the global status quo. Both provide avenues for gas lighting (blaming the victims for being “losers”) and diversion. Both versions are basically the same. Both versions, in other words, came from the same ugly place. Both versions present limited, narrow, and exclusionary visions of this universe that we live in, and neither one offers much in the way of a choice. Behind door number one you get violent Darwinian struggle of the fittest. Behind door number two you get submission to a sadistic, divine authority that doesn’t seem to care or have a clue. Both visions suck, and in a big way.

However, there is an alternative.

But you know what, that does not matter because what you and I see when we see “normal” reality is really only the surface of a much larger reality with a much deeper purpose and meaning than we are used to seeing in our normal lives. Indeed, the normal reality seen by your average, somnambulistic human being is, contra Freud and Jung, *not even the tip of the iceberg* of what lies beneath the surface. If I may wax poetic for a moment, what you see when you look at the world around you is merely the *meniscus* on the water of the Consciousness of God. What “normal” people call “normal” reality is merely a thin crust beneath which expands a reality so vast and so grand that if you were to poke a hole through that membrane without preparation, if you were to even get a glimpse of the *power and the glory* while still caught deep in the **Maya**³³ (i.e. the illusion and delusion) of the world, you would experience, depending on the number of erroneous ideas you have about the universe you live in, various levels of discomfort, distress, and even discombobulation. The truth is, *beneath the meniscus that separates your work-a-day reality from the vast ocean that lies beneath is a reality that is so vast and so grand that it boggles the sleeping egoic mind and terrifies the dogmatically straightjacketed*

³³<https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Maya>

consciousness. It can literally be the stuff of some people's nightmares. Let me just say, it is big—much bigger than even your wildest “normal” dreams.

Now, do not misunderstand me, and do not get all freaked out. I am not trying to impress you or scare you. I do not want you to think that the depths of consciousness are too much for you (or anyone) to handle. In fact, quite the opposite. Indeed, let me be the first person to tell you that *the water that expands into infinity beneath the meniscus is your home reality*. That reality is where you come from and not so long ago you were like a fish, swimming and at home in this vast cosmic ocean of Consciousness, as comfortable in the breadth and the depth as a guppy is in a pond.

So if you come from that place, and if you were once comfortable in **The Water**,³⁴ why am I attaching this warning label? Well, the problem is not that “You” (with a big “Y”) can't handle it (and by “You” I mean your immortal, conscious soul (i.e., your **Spiritual Ego**³⁵). The problem is that you (and by “you” I mean your body/mind or **Bodily Ego**³⁶ can't handle it. The problem is, your waking mind, your bodily mind, your

³⁴https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/The_Water

³⁵https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Spiritual_Ego

³⁶https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Bodily_Ego

bodily ego, that part of you that emerges out of the firing of neuronal synapses in your brain, is simply out of touch with the power and the glory of its animating consciousness. Let us face it. When it comes to things of a spiritual nature, your bodily ego, trained as it is in a culture and society that knows next to nothing about the true power and glory of Consciousness, is clueless and at a decided disadvantage.

And why is your physical unit so clueless about spirituality and Consciousness? To make a long story short, you (and by you I mean your body/mind) have been cut off by a socialization and child-rearing process that is decidedly hostile to **authentic spirituality**³⁷ and high conscious experience. I call this child-rearing process **Toxic Socialization**³⁸ because it is toxic to your connection with Consciousness. The problem is that although the vast divine reality is something you come from, and although it was open to you as a child, and although as a child you were comfortable in that reality, as you grew older your understanding of it was never nurtured. In fact, exactly the opposite happened. As you grew up, your understanding, your connection to

³⁷Authentic spirituality is one that connects you to Consciousness. See

https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Authentic_Spirituality

³⁸https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Toxic_Socialization/

Consciousness was crushed. As part of the spiritually hostile socialization you received on this world, your connection was severed, smashed, torn apart, ripped asunder, and shredded. You were taught by your parents, by your teachers, by your priests, by your pundits, and by the media to “leave it behind,” “stay here,” and stay focused in something that they like to call “normal” reality. You were taught, through constant tests, punishments, consequences, and reminders, of the precarious nature of your physical existence. You were taught to stay focused and present (I would say locked) into the “normal” here and now. In order to reinforce that disconnection, you were taught to fear the other side. You were fed silliness about ghosts, goblins, and scary bogeymen like the mythological Satan and his army of twisted demon torturers. The result for you, for all of us, was almost total, and often pathological, disconnection from the higher Consciousness that animates your physical body, and underlies our entire reality.

Of course, at this juncture, in this moment of realization, you probably do not notice that anything is missing. Indeed, at this juncture you probably have no idea that your connection to a wider reality, a vast “space” of conscious existence, does not exist anymore. It is a frog in boiling water sort of thing. Since “they”

get you early, the loss is gradual and unnoticeable. By the time you are an adult (or more technically correct, by the time you attain what counts for “adult” status on this planet), it is gone and you do not miss it. Sadly, any abilities or sensibilities that you had as a child that were attached to the bigger reality, things like intuition, telepathy, and other nascent skills that need, like language, to be nurtured, are also gone. Like anything, lack of use means atrophy and since the higher reality is closed off from an early age, by the time you are an adult you have no remembered experience, no memory, no leftover skills, and (most important for this discussion) *no ability to deal with the power and the glory should you inadvertently come into contact with it*. By the time you are an adult, the deeper reality is as foreign and strange, startling and striking (to the narrow consciousness of your bodily ego) as life in another universe would be. Stranger, in fact, and, thanks to the priests, pundits and scientists of this planet who fill your head with demons, devils, and Darwinian predators, discombobulating and frightening—especially if you are coming at it from spiritual/mystical cold turkey, which almost all of us do.

Now, if the nascent spiritual connection you enjoyed as a newborn had been nurtured in you, if your highly sensitive body and mind had been protected rather than

subjected to decades of violence and abuse, it wouldn't be this way. If things were different, you would be as comfortable swimming in high Consciousness as a guppy in a pond. Unfortunately, things are the way they are and as a result, you have a problem. That problem is how to access and deal with the awesome power and glory of your own high Consciousness. Therefore, at this moment, right here and right now, and while I have your focused and undivided attention, allow me to ask you the question directly. How are you going to deal with the awesome power and glory of your own higher Consciousness when it finally comes blasting through the meniscus?

Well, as I said earlier, if you want to learn to handle that, there is a lot to do. From building self-confidence and trust to initiating the descent of Consciousness to revising all the **Old Energy Archetypes**³⁹ in your head, to actually embracing and grounding your own higher self, it is work, work, work. From this moment forward, and in all subsequent Lightning Path materials, I will provide the groundwork, concepts, and technique that you need to safely initiate the expansion of Consciousness into the body, and safely process and ground your own higher Consciousness. It won't be

³⁹https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Old_Energy_Archetypes

without challenge, but at the same time it won't take as long as you might think. Remember, not so long ago you were like a fish swimming in the water, and although we would not want to just throw you back in unprepared, with a little good advice and guidance, and a little bit of time and practice, you won't have any problem acclimating to the powerful realities that lie just beneath the thin meniscus of our now rapidly disintegrating normal reality.

Breathing

But, I'm jumping ahead. Right now, I want to highlight the potentially dramatic nature of some of the experiences that may lie ahead and *strongly* advise you that if you want to increase the probability that you will handle those experiences properly, then you best start learning to breathe properly right away. In the context of this discussion of the deep waters of Consciousness, and with the understanding that you have not been prepared to handle these deep waters, breathing (or rather *deep breathing*) is the single most important tool that you need to have in your spiritual repertoire. *If you are going to go poking at the meniscus of this conscious universe, you are going to need to learn to breathe.* Indeed, in the context of the discussions in this chapter, breathing is a tool that you cannot ignore. If you want to be able to move forward into the full light of Consciousness and awareness, you must learn how to breathe properly because breathing, more than anything else, has incredible ability to ground, enliven, enlighten, awaken, and empower. Bottom line is, breathing will help keep your *egoic* consciousness (i.e. your bodily consciousness, or *bodily ego*) safe and secure as it takes its first tentative dips into the depths

of Consciousness. I'll say it now and I'll say it again and again, breathing is important.

Now, I know I am making breathing (or rather *deep* breathing) sound impressive and important, and it is. What is even more outstanding about it is that breathing is not a difficult tool to master. In fact, even as breathing is the most important tool in this book, it is also the easiest tool to use. *The trick is simply remembering to do it when you need to do it.* It can be a challenge at first, especially since deep breathing is often the last thing you think about when you are dealing with anxiety and stress, but you need to get into the habit of doing it when you need to be doing it.

Of course, the question is, when do you need to do it? The answer is, you need to deep breathe whenever you are doing any kind of spiritual work whatsoever, and especially when that spiritual work is causing you anxiety, fear, or distress! Whenever you approach the meniscus of Consciousness, whenever you stick your little toe into the deep waters, whenever you are feeling anxious about what's happening, whenever you are feeling unsure of yourself, whenever fear is rising in you, whenever you are agitated by "things" around you (spiritual or otherwise), simply disconnect from

whatever it is that you are engaged in in that moment, focus on your breath, and breathe.

Allow me to demonstrate.

Close your eyes and take ten very deep breaths.

Breathe in until you cannot breathe in any more, hold for a moment, and then exhale, calmly, gently, and with control. Do not force the air into your lungs; do not force the air out of your lungs. Simply fill them to their expanding capacity and release the air in a calm and gentle manner.

Expand your lungs, stretch them to the limit, and exhale.

Ready?

Do it with me now.

Breathe in... and exhale...

Breathe in... and exhale...

Put the book down now, close your eyes, focus, and do it eight more times with me.

Go.

...

Are you done?

Then welcome back.

Now pause for a moment and pay attention to the state of your bodily consciousness as you exit from the deep breathing exercise.

Do you notice the shift?

At the very minimum, when you deep breathe like that you will notice several things. For example, and assuming you are not brutally exhausted and at the end of a long day, you will notice that, as a result of the extra oxygen going to your brain, your mental alertness will have increased, even if only slightly. You will also find yourself more focused and more tuned in. You will also notice a subtle (and sometimes not so subtle) shift in consciousness. What exactly that shift will be will be different for different people. Indeed, what it is will depend on what you are shifting out of and what you are shifting into. For example, if before your ten breaths you were feeling anxiety, afterward you will have shifted, and there will be less anxiety. If before breathing you were feeling buzzy and ungrounded, afterward you will have shifted and you will be more grounded and calm. If before you were lacking presence in the moment, after you will be more present. If before you were experiencing fear, afterward you will have calmed down.

Now, the first few times you do this, the shift will likely be subtle and difficult to discern (unless of course you are dealing with high levels of fear and panic). There may also be a sense of randomness to it all, especially if you are just sitting down in a quiet room to practice your deep breathing. Be aware however that you can control and enhance the experience of breathing. You can make it more concrete and useful, and set the direction of the shift, simply by realizing you have control over the impact of the breathing exercises that you undertake. To control the impact of your breathing, i.e. to take control of the outcome and set direction, tone, and impact, combine your breathing exercises with statements of will, intent, and even visualization. If you need to ground yourself, just say as you breathe, “I want to be more grounded.” If you need to calm down then with each breath say (aloud or in your head), “Calm down.” If you want to become more aware, then each time you breathe say “I am becoming more aware.” If you want Consciousness to descend into the vessel, then say something like “I wish for Consciousness to expand into this vessel.” *Whatever you need to do, whatever you want to do, intend it and breathe*—that is all there is to it.

Now, I cannot overestimate the importance of breathing. As you progress in your spiritual awakening

process in the days and weeks ahead, breathing will be an important exercise for you, so practice it all the time because the more you practice it, the more it will work for you, and the more likely you will do it when you need to do it. It is physiological, primordial, deep magic programmed into the very core reality of your body and mind, so learn to do it. And do not let the simplicity of the exercise fool you. It is simple, but it is powerful. No matter how prosaic I might become, I cannot overestimate the importance of breathing. The high truth is this: breathing is primordial; breathing is archetypal; breathing is divine. If you want to get right down to it, breathing is the first act of creation. Breathing is what the original **Monadic Consciousness**,⁴⁰ the original spark of Light, did upon deciding to create. Indeed, breathing *is* the ongoing act of creation and as such, it reverberates and is reflected at every layer of reality, in every universe, and at every stage of **The Unfolding**,⁴¹ throughout all of creation. Breathing is literally “the word” of God (Divine Logos) and as such it is powerful beyond measure. Know that breathing is the single most calming, grounding, life-affirming, manifestation-supporting exercise that you

⁴⁰https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Monadic_Consciousness

⁴¹https://www.thespiritwiki.com/The_Unfolding

can do. When you are feeling anxious, when you are under stress, when you feel threatened, when anxiety wells up, when fear rises up, when you want to change direction, when you want to manifest something new, deep breathing helps.

Breathe deep and say to yourself “I wish clarity,” and you will have it!

Breathe deep and say to yourself “I want to awaken,” and the universe will take note and begin moving the energies in order to fulfill.

Take breathing seriously because really, when you think about it, breathing is more important than even food and water for the continuation of your healthy life. You can go weeks without food, days without water, but only seconds without air. Learn to deep breathe and make it a habit throughout your day. The practice is powerful beyond measure and doing it regularly and properly will help carry you through the challenging emotional, psychological, and spiritual “shifting” experiences that lie directly ahead.

Trust and Self Confidence

*When you are a Bear of Very Little
Brain, and you Think of Things,
you sometimes find that a Thing
which seemed very Thingish
inside you is quite different when
it gets out into the open and has
other people looking at it. ~*

Winnie the Pooh

In the last section of this spiritual primer I spoke at some length about the importance of deep breathing. As I said, breathing is important to the grounding process. Breathing helps with energy generation, and it encourages subtle and positive shifts in consciousness; therefore, do not forget the lessons on breathing. Good breathing practice is important at all levels of spiritual awakening and activation and is something you should practice on a daily basis.

Once you have deep breathing and grounding under control, and once you have practiced and built these into a daily routine, the next step in the process of opening up to the higher realities, the next step in developing what I would call a strong connection to

Consciousness, is to learn to trust. More specifically, *the next step is to learn to trust in the spirit world, the Consciousness behind creation, and your own ability to navigate and control the process.* If you are going to make any forward progress at all, you are going to have to be able to trust in God, Spirit, your spiritual guide network, the efficacy of the spiritual realm, and the general love that is behind and beneath all manifested creation. Not only this, you are also going to have to trust in your ability to control things as you begin to navigate the spiritual halls of consciousness. Trust that God is love, trust that Spirit does not wish anything bad to happen to you, and trust that you have the ability to find your way through to the “other side” under your own steam and guidance. Trusting is important, and I cannot underline it enough. Like the issues of hatred and anger mentioned earlier, if you do not trust, you will not be able to wake up.

You can understand why I say trust is important if you consider the ugly way that spirituality has been taught to many of us. As infants, children, teenagers, and even adults, we are all taught to fear and distrust the spirit realm, and this goes for East or West, spiritually inclined or atheistically bent. If we are raised in western religious traditions we are told awful stories about our failure in The Garden, awful lies about an abusive,

judgmental, and punishing “father” in heaven, and scary tales of demons, devils, hell, and purgatory. Essentially, we are told lies about a violent and hostile spiritual realm. Not only that, we are repeatedly told lies about who we really are,⁴² and reminded of our own impotent insignificance. We are told that, in the grander scheme of things, we are less than nothing—throw away souls fit for annihilation in the fire if we do not perform according to the rules. It is a terrible story of our utter spiritual incompetence, which, in addition to scaring the bejesus out of our inner child, diminishes us to the point of insignificance and virtual spiritual non-existence. It diminishes us so much that even the idea of confronting our inner divinity terrifies us. As a result, *we build a thick wall between our waking consciousness and the **Fabric of Consciousness**⁴³ (or just Fabric for short) and spin ourselves in circles out of a deep fear of moving forward and confronting our awesome glory.* It is a terrible condition to be in because the whole ideological shebang blocks us from authentic connection with our own higher self. *We might pretend*

⁴²And who are we? While I talk about who we/you really are in *The Book of Light*, let me just leave you with the words of one of this world’s most famous mystics. “Is it not written in your law, ‘I have said you are gods.’” John 10:34.

⁴³https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Fabric_of_Consciousness

we are connected, but fear and anxiety keep us in a state of spiritual avoidance and disconnection. Worse still, should we actually come into contact with higher spiritual realities, deep anxiety, fear, and even paranoid ideation (rooted in all the scary lies we were told) may be invoked and this may send us reeling from our own higher Consciousness.

For those of you who consider yourself outside the influence of traditional religious dogma, do not think you are off the hook. Just because you were not raised with fire and brimstone ideology, just because you may have renounced the twisted beliefs of fear-based spiritual systems at an early age, does not mean you have not been impacted by fear-based spiritual dogma. Even if your parents were atheist, rational, and scientific, you are still exposed to the fearful stories of dogmatic religion in fairy tales, social myths, and holiday pageantry, (e.g. Christmas exposes us to a judgmental celestial patriarch just as much as Christianity does). It is hard to avoid the indoctrination, and it is hard to avoid being affected by it. Indeed, since the indoctrination occurs when you are very young it becomes embedded beneath a veneer of rationality. You may believe that you have put aside the fears, but they may remain active deep down inside all the same. Of course, since you are of a scientific bent

you may dismiss spiritual or occult investigation, and avoid attempts to connect altogether. Thus, you may never activate the fears. This does not mean they are not there. It just means they are never activated. This can change and the fears can easily be activated should you change your mind and investigate the spiritual realms. If so, if you do find dogmatic fears of a hostile universe rising in your consciousness as you explore the hallways of consciousness, keep in mind the advice offered above and below—breathe, be open, trust, and be self-confident. The demons may appear violent and dangerous, but they are only reflections of the fairytale archetypes imposed upon you when you were too young to defend against the onslaught.

Of course, it is not always the case that we have deep spiritual fears to deal with. Some avoid the fear-based indoctrination. However, even if you are fortunate enough to avoid the indoctrination of *old energy* dogmas you may still run up against a more “rationally” based set of fears. The truth is, scientists and others of a more atheistic persuasion can just as easily mistrust, fear, and be terrified of spiritual experience and the Fabric of Consciousness as any fundamentalist Christian ever was, though the root of the fear is different. Whereas those indoctrinated into the

Blocking Fears⁴⁴ of religious dogma fear demons, devils, and a punishing God/Cosmos, those indoctrinated into blocking fears the dogma of science fear ridicule, madness, ostracization, social exclusion, and even professional censure. Atheists are told, for example, that the spiritual world is for children, for animists, for primitives, or for schizophrenics. Atheists are told that the rational people, the smart people, the “above the curve” people, have no use for primitive animisms or pantheistic spiritualities. Atheists are told that these are relics of the bygone days of primitive superstition, and that spiritual sentiment is a sign of a weakness that should be dominated and suppressed, overcome and controlled by the rational mind. Atheists must thus rise above the masses of primitive sheeple who believe in stupid superstitions.

After hearing these things from parents, professors, pundits, and colleagues, it is no surprise that so many rational people turn their backs on spirituality altogether? Human physical units are nothing if not programmed to seek out social acceptance. It is an evolutionary thing; it is a survival thing. When open spiritual inquiry threatens our social and professional acceptance, we develop deep fear and anxiety. In this

⁴⁴https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Blocking_Fears

context, even simple open discussion becomes a threat to our acceptance (or even our jobs). Spirituality becomes something to fear, a sign of our primitive animism, our lack of intelligence, our weakness, and something that we must avoid lest we face the painful sting of exclusion and banishment. In this context, we might maintain a professionally safe academic interest, but more likely than not we reject even the idea of open inquiry with dismissive, inquisitorial derision.⁴⁵ We might even become hostile, going so far as to hunt down, expose, and excommunicate the heretics, as for example some scientists did when Rupert Sheldrake dared to question the materialist foundations of science.⁴⁶ If we consider spirituality at all, it is only on the surface, and only as an object. We objectify it, poke it, prod it, observe others experiencing it, but never

⁴⁵As for example is Peter Berger in *The Desecularization of the World*, 1999. Berger, a sociologist with a specialization in religion, suggests that certain aspects of spirituality, what he calls reactionary super naturalism, shouldn't be discussed at "respectable" academic parties. It is a derisive and dismissive attitude unfit for an academy of open-minded scholars. That a sociologist with a specialization in religion should display such a dogmatic and closed off attitude towards his chosen area of inquiry is an embarrassment to the practice of science.

⁴⁶See https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Rupert_Sheldrake. Also see Arthur Versluis, *Magic and Mysticism: An Introduction to Western Esotericism*, 2007. Versluis notes that Western science has a long history of irrational rejection of mystical areas of inquiry.

really get very close to it ourselves for fear of ridicule and rejection. After all, what would our colleagues think? We essentially close our eyes to aspects of reality that we do not wish to believe exist, and then strut like peacocks proudly proclaiming that since we cannot see it, it must, therefore, not be.

Of course, turning our backs on spirituality and rejecting open inquiry (becoming closed-minded) is not the most damaging thing we do. Ultimately, the adoption of what I would call **Spiritual Ideology**⁴⁷ damages our ability to have spiritual experiences altogether. When we adopt spiritual ideology, we undermine even a nascent connection; we cut it off just like cutting off one of our own appendages. It is not hard to do. Spiritual experiences are potentially powerful, but as I like to say, *as above in consciousness, so below in matter*. The ideas in our consciousness control reality. Turning our back on spiritual experiences, dismissing the possibility of authentic connection, and deriding those who step outside the materialist box as reactionary and stupid, creates a reality where authentic spiritual experience is impossible. As a result of our cynical and dismissive attitude, we erase the potential from our existence

⁴⁷https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Spiritual_Ideology

altogether. Of course, sometimes crises, disease, or trauma may break through even seemingly impenetrable boundaries, but in those instances we may still dismiss our *connection experience* as delusion or pathology no matter how powerful and valid they may be. It is a self-amputation of spiritual potential of the most appalling and self-destructive kind.

Scientific anti-spiritual dogma and religion-based fear are only two examples at the extreme opposite ends of a continuum of spiritual blockage that causes us to build a wall between our little ego, our little "i, and the much bigger "I" that exists on the other side of the meniscus. Between the two extremes there are many points, many combinations of beliefs, and many subtle ways to erase our ability to see, perceive, and experience higher realities. If the thought of this makes your head spin, do not worry. Thankfully, we do not have to rehearse all the errors, or painstakingly excavate all prejudice and irrational fear. As I said earlier, no matter what your fears are, it is relatively easy to traverse to the other side; it is also relatively easy to overcome scientific misconception and erroneous theorization. All you need is to do a few simple things.

The first thing you need to do, as already noted, is *trust*. If you come from a dogmatic religious background where God was portrayed as abusive, where karma is all about punishment, and where higher realms are populated by demons, devils, and other entities out to get you, put those fears aside and trust that this is not actually the way the universe works, which it is not.⁴⁸ Angry, hateful, violent entities do exist, but these are not essential features of a violent universe; they are the inevitable outcome of the suffering, pain, and abuse we all experience while incarnated on this Earth. More important to realize, negative entities may have power in the physical realm, but in the realms of Consciousness, they have power only if you give it to them! So, do not give it to them. Instead, keep your power and embrace the truth. Beyond the essential healing that must occur, beyond the economic and political transformation that awaits us just around the corner, and beyond the flowering of Consciousness now occurring on this planet, there lies a vast and positive universe of joyful experience. Therefore, if fear, anxiety, and hatred are invoked in you, know that these experiences, these impressions in consciousness, arise from archetypes *imposed* on you—they do not reflect the deep spiritual truths of creation. When (and if) you

⁴⁸See Michael Sharp, the Book of Light Volume One.

do experience the negative fears and archetypes imposed by spiritual and/or scientific indoctrination, do not turn around and flee; simply face them down and reject them as the lies they actually are. Take deep breaths, ground your Consciousness, reject the fear, and push through.

It is important to note, if you come from a dogmatic scientific background, trust is equally important. In order to create even the possibility of authentic *spiritual experience* you are going to have to trust both in your ability to handle the social and professional minefield, and trust in the authentic and mature nature of spiritual experiences. Trust in your own rationality, trust in the strength of your intellect, trust in your ability to work through complications and challenges, trust that having an experience is not a sign of primitive stupidity, irrationality, or neurotic or psychotic breakdown. Trust is key, even for a scientist.

Beyond the general advice to trust, **the second thing** you have to do is *keep an open mind*. We live in a conscious universe and Consciousness determines the nature and shape of this universe. This is true in a *practical sense*, as for example when the consciousness of an engineer creates a bridge plan that is then implemented by contractors and workers. This is true

in a *social sense*, as when our ideas about who we are and what we can do determine who we are and what we can do.⁴⁹ This is also true in a *mystical sense*, as for example when the potentials of our experience are fundamentally altered because of the way we think about the world. If you believe that there is nothing at all to be said for spiritual or mystical experience, if you believe these things do not exist, not only do you create a conceptual barrier between yourself and authentic spiritual experience, but *you alter the potential of your physical unit and undermine its ability to see, perceive, and experience* higher realms. If you do that, you are cutting off your hand to spite your arm.

⁴⁹The history of feminist struggle against the limiting ideas of gender is instructive here. There was a time not so long ago when people thought that women could accomplish nothing because they were weak, stupid, and unevolved. Our collective thoughts about women, the ideas in our consciousness, were reflected in the psychological, social and political realities that we created not even a century ago. Women accepted the ideology and became passive and unambitious. Not only that, but economy and policy were set up to reject female potential and keep women down. The struggle of this century has been the struggle to change first our ideas about gender, and then the reality of our times as well. Thankfully, times have changed, but the struggle has been from the start a struggle to change our ideas.

Being open and trusting will go a long way towards creating conditions where you will be able to experience higher realities, pure consciousness events,⁵⁰ mystical experiences, etc. Beyond this, the **third thing** you should do is think for yourself. Thinking is not that hard really. Thinking simply requires you to roll concepts around in your mind, put ideas together, compare them, and so on; but you have to know, thinking *requires* concepts and ideas. If you do not have any concepts and ideas, you can't think. Of course, concepts and ideas have been poured into your head since the moment you were born onto this Earth, so we all have concepts and ideas. It is more important to say that the concepts you use determine how and what you think. The problem is that many of the concepts we use to think about spirituality are misplaced and erroneous. There is what I would call a lot of **Wrong Thought**.⁵¹ Wrong Thought, which may be distinguished from **Right Thought**,⁵² is thought that prevents you from connecting to Consciousness. Therefore, if you are interested in authentic spiritual connection, you have to

⁵⁰Robert K. C. Forman, *Mysticism, Mind, Consciousness*, 1999.

⁵¹https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Wrong_Thought

⁵²https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Right_Thought

- a) Pay attention/query the concepts, ideas, and archetypes you have in your head,
- b) Expand conceptualizations as necessary to encourage spiritual awakening and connection and
- c) Exorcise old energy ideas, as needed, to create a conceptual space of *right thought* suitable and conducive to the expansion of Consciousness into the body.

For example, if you think of creation as the act of a violent celestial patriarch, then your thoughts and ideas about creation will revolve around that single, limiting concept. However, if you expand your head space and add the Fabric of Consciousness as an idea to that space, suddenly your thinking about cosmology, consciousness, and creation changes and expands. The bottom line is, there is a lot more to think about when you do not box yourself in with celestial patriarchs. The truth is, if you want to think better about creation, expand the number and quality of concepts you use to understand and think about God, Consciousness, creation, mystical experience, and so on.

Of course, and as noted above, this goes both ways. If you want to think better about creation you should add concepts, but you should also subtract them. Some

concepts, like the concept of **hell**⁵³ for example, do not belong in an authentic spirituality. Concepts like *hell* make you think about things (like horribly punishing people for their transgressions) that you would not naturally think about if didn't have that idea in your head. This is not a good thing because concepts like *hell* focus you on ideas, like punishment and retribution, that are not in **alignment**⁵⁴ with the loving, compassionate, forgiving, healing nature of God. Put another way, concepts like hell cause **disjuncture**⁵⁵ and therefore prevent authentic connection. Concepts like hell should either be redefined (as I do when I define hell as the painful emotional and psychological states we experience when we live with disjuncture) or eliminated altogether and replaced with ideas of healing and restitution.

Finally, remember the earlier admonishment to breathe. It can all sound very simple and straightforward to deal with when written on paper in this fashion, but our fears can take on frightening reality when powered by the pure fire of higher Consciousness. In situations when fear, anxiety, and panic bubble up to the surface, remember not only to

⁵³<https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Hell>

⁵⁴<https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Alignment>

⁵⁵<https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Disjuncture>

trust but to breathe as well. When the time comes and fears do bubble up, it is a simple choice that you will make. You will either trust and move forward, or cave to your fear and move back. If you cave to your fear, that is OK. That happens to all of us. Do not be too hard on yourself. Sometimes it is easy, sometimes it is not. Sometimes our experience can be nothing more than a peak experience or an empty sense of awareness, sometimes it can be visceral encounters with inner demons, and even dramatic discombobulations as the high truths come bubbling up to smash your preconceived notions of reality. When that happens there is often nothing in our previous spiritual, religious, primary, post-secondary, or scientific training that prepares us for the raw power and glory of our own inner light. In these cases, fear, shock, and awe may knock you to your knees. If that happens, avoid the temptation to step off the path or beat yourself down for stupid, fearful, incompetence. Everybody falls at some point. Simply stand up, dust yourself off, take as long as you want to compose yourself, evaluate the experience, and try again. That is all there is to it. *As long as you do not give up, your day will come.* Until then, do not worry yourself about it. Have some fun and take some playtime. Just remember, develop confidence, trust, and establish right thought! When

you do come to the point where you have to confront your demons, inhale, exhale, be calm, trust, and remember this: in this great awakening process that we are now undergoing, there is nothing to fear. *We are like a fish in the waters of consciousness; we are at home in the powerful and glorious Consciousness of creation; so trust, be open, and move forward.*

Ignition

*Did you ever stop to think, and
forget to start again? ~ Winnie
the Pooh*

So far in this book we have talked about trust, breathing, and right thinking. These are the proper foundations for your awakening process. Once you have practiced these things for a bit, and once they have become a habitual thing, then it is time to consider “starting the engines.” Thankfully, like all things spiritual, starting the engines on your physical unit is not that hard. In fact, when you are ready, when you are trusting and breathing, when you are open and accepting, when you are thinking nice thoughts and are at peace with an emerging new vision of reality that does not include all the hierarchy and rejection, poverty and suffering, war and chaos of the old way of thinking,⁵⁶ then “starting the engines” is quite easy. *When you are ready, and only you know when you are ready, all you have to do to get the ball rolling is set your intent. Simply “decide” that you want to awaken then will it to happen.*

⁵⁶See Michael Sharp, *The Book of Light Volume One* for this alternative vision of reality.

Willfully draw yourself up.

Willfully awaken.

It is easy, and contrary to what you might have been told, it is not a mystical or magical process (though it will certainly lead to mystical experiences), nor does it require accoutrements, ritual, pomp, or even the assistance of specially trained hierophants. Spiritual awakening is a very straightforward, very grounded, very sensible, and very rational sort of process that starts when you make a decision, and intend it to be so.

What else is there to say about it?

Just do it like you do every morning. Every morning when you wake up from your night's sleep, you open your eyes, pull your Consciousness back into your body, and drag your body out of bed. Waking up in the morning is as simple as that. You set your intent and you *will it* to happen. It is exactly the same with spiritual awakening. You set your intent and you will it to happen. I know this might sound like a bit of a letdown to some (especially if you were expecting temples, alters, crystals, and other mystical, magical silliness), and a lot of nonsense to others, but it is not. Intent, otherwise known as will, is a critical component of everything you do. From something as simple as

opening your hands or getting up in the morning, to more complex tasks like cooking breakfast, going to work, or loving your kids, intent/will is key. When you think about it, the only thing you do not need intent for is dying. Dying is the only thing that happens without will. For everything else, living included, intent is important. In fact, it is so important, so basic, that you will find that this "intent" thing works amazingly well, especially with something as easy and well-practiced as waking up to your full consciousness.⁵⁷ A little bit of intent, a little bit of effort, some good guidance, and there you go.

Now, willing your hands to open or dragging yourself out of bed in the morning are relatively straightforward tasks. Intending them to happen is easy, as is seeing the results of that intent. It is a bit more complicated when you initiate spiritual awakening. When you will yourself spiritually awake, when you initiate the descent of Consciousness into the body, you may not see immediate (as in next second) results, and even if you do, the results may not be what you might expect. Without going into a lot of detail at this level of study, let me just say that our preconceived notions about

⁵⁷I say waking up to full consciousness is well practiced because you have been practicing it, through a dozen or more lifetimes, for several thousand years now.

what it means to be spiritual and mystical are often quite messed up and confused. They are messed up and confused by the darkness of **The Blindfold**⁵⁸, or corrupted by the efforts of those who would rather see us asleep and befuddled. As a result, what happens in the process can be counterintuitive, at least initially, and shocking, if you are not prepared. The whole thing may even seem counterproductive, in the beginning. As a result, you may have doubts, at least at the start. These doubts may cause you to put down the book, forget your spiritual practice (e.g. breathing and intent), walk away from the path, and settle back down into “normal” life for all the rest of your days. Keep with it long enough and miracles will happen, but end it too soon and you will settle back into normal existence without ever really giving it a fair shot.

So what are you going to do? That is easy. *The key to success in the early stages of your spiritual **initiation**⁵⁹ process will be persistent and consistent will, and faith.* You need to be persistent, and you need faith. Not faith of the wrong kind, but faith of the right kind. Not faith of the blind kind, but faith of the kind that you get when you study hard and know you will pass a test. Not

⁵⁸<https://www.michaelsharp.org/parables/parable-of-the-blindfold/>

⁵⁹<https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Initiation/>

faith of the ungrounded kind, but faith of the kind that comes from training hard to run a marathon and knowing you will make it to the end. You need faith of the kind that you get when you work hard at something and you will eventually get it done. If you are going to navigate the awakening and activation process ahead of you, you must have this type of faith. Have faith that if you keep intending, keep willing, and keep close attention, you will eventually achieve an expansion of consciousness, a shift, and a watershed change in reality.

As with the general process of *initiation*, there is nothing particularly mystical, magical, or ungrounded about faith. It will help you to keep the faith if you keep your will and intent persistent, consistent, and pure. The best way to set your intent and keep it consistent is with an *affirmation* of some sort. Affirmation is basically a statement of intent, a statement of will, that guides the direction of manifestation. A simple but very powerful awakening mantra is this: “I wish to wake up” or “I wish to move forward.” When you affirm your desire to awaken and move forward, reality begins to change. When you affirm you want to wake up, Consciousness begins to descend into the vessel.

Affirmation works at several levels. For example, there is a mundane aspect to this. If you have unpleasant chores to do in your house, like taking a load of garbage to the dump, you might increase the chances that this actually gets done by saying to yourself the day before, “Tomorrow, I will take a load to the dump.” In this way, you motivate yourself to get the job done. You set an expectation for yourself (and those around you), you maybe get the load ready the night before, you go to bed earlier, your spouse makes you breakfast, or whatever. The point is, setting an intent, even stating that verbally to those around you, helps set an expectation and an energy in motion.

As noted, affirmation like this can be very helpful at mundane levels, but it is also a significant factor at mystical/spiritual levels as well. We live in a universe of energy and the direction of energy is set in consciousness by statements (or visions) of willful intent. *As above in consciousness, so below in matter*, as I like to say. Setting willful intent not only encourages you to create physical conditions conducive to manifestation of particular things, it also draws energy in. Remember this spiritual truism: *persistent and consistent intent can have a major impact on spiritual aspects of your life.*

There are a number of ways to set spiritual intent to awaken and activate. For example, say often and with conviction, out loud or to yourself, “I wish to wake into full consciousness as fast and as safely as possible.” Repeat this affirmation not once a day, not twice a day, but multiple times throughout the day, whenever you can remember. Be persistent and insistent about this. Say, “I wish to move forward,” and do not take no for an answer. Do not give in to fear, do not give in to any ideas about your own insignificance or unworthiness, do not listen to anything about your “sin” or your icky karmic debt, do not be fooled by scientific prejudice, and do not lose faith. The deep Fabric of Consciousness is real, far more real than the material “reality” of the world around you. They lie just beneath the surface of your “normal” reality. So, breathe, trust, think nice thoughts, and intend yourself awake. Be persistent and insistent, aware and open, trusting and ready to breathe; before you know it, subtle (and perhaps not so subtle) shifts and awakenings will begin to occur. As they do, embrace the shifts. Take the opportunity provided to remove blockage, expand awareness, and wake up. It will happen, and it all starts with a simple awakening mantra. I wish to wake up; I wish to wake up; I wish to wake up.

Part Two: Driving the Roads of Creation

Steering

*It is more fun to talk with
someone who doesn't use long,
difficult words but rather short,
easy words like "What about
lunch?" ~ Winnie the Pooh*

In part one of this book, I discussed several concepts and techniques important for your own spiritual awakening process. I discussed right thinking, breathing, intent, and trust. These are all concepts and techniques that you need if you are going to be able to initiate and navigate your own awakening process. In part two of this book I would like to move beyond the basic “get in your car and start the engine” advice of the previous section and talk more about how to actually steer your vehicle (i.e., your physical unit) and drive it safely through the energetic roadways of creation. Once again, and as I am fond of repeating, the advice and technique provided in this book isn’t hard. It is all basic stuff. You should find that once you get going, once you start your practice, things will start to fall into place pretty quickly.

Now, we'll start off our "driving advice" in this chapter by taking a look at the body's primary steering mechanism, visualization. In this chapter, you will learn about the power and importance of this simple but effective tool for directing the flow of your life. Of course, we won't stop with visualization. After we finish our discussion in this chapter, we will move on to discuss things like road safety, how to communicate with other drivers (intuition, synchronicity, channeling, etc.), how to maintain the energetic balance of your physical vehicle, and how to properly feed, water, and heal to keep the vehicle running at top efficiency. We begin, however, with visualization.

So, what is visualization? *Well, visualization is the ability to "see things" in your brain, or draw a picture in your mind's eye.* That is all there is to it. If you can imagine something in your brain, with your eyes closed if necessary, you are visualizing. It is quite simple; however, as with breathing, do not let the simplicity fool you. Like breathing, visualization is a powerful tool. In fact, in terms of your ability to awaken, activate, and steer your way through life, visualization is critical. I can tell you right now, in terms of awakening and activation, you will not get very far very fast if you do not learn visualization. The bottom line is, visualization is a fundamental technique: *visualization is quite*

literally the “steering wheel” of your physical vehicle, the steering wheel of creation. To be blunt, visualization is what controls what exists in the world you experience. It is important stuff; so important in fact that it should be taught in grade school. Sadly, however, it is not. In fact, past maybe grade two, visualization-friendly activities like painting or dance are actively discouraged, or improperly funded, in favor of more “practical” skills. However, despite this fact, and as more and more people are beginning to recognize, we should definitely learn (or rather re-learn) to visualize. *Visualization is a powerful way to direct your life and if you do not learn to visualize, then you give up the best opportunity you have to control the world you experience.* What’s more, if you do not visualize, then (as we shall see in more detail next chapter) you are pretty much at the mercy of whatever other visions of reality happen to be operating in your area. Frankly, given some of the ugly visions of reality that are operating these days, leaving yourself open to somebody else’s visualization of reality could be hazardous to your health. And it really does not matter whose vision of reality it might be. It could be your neighbor, your local politician, some Rothschild sitting in a brown room somewhere, the pope, the president, or even your mom and dad. As I noted in part one, there

are many weird ideas about the way creation works, and you just never know what people “have in mind” (either consciously or unconsciously) for you. *Word to the wise: steer your own course and manifest your own world by using the basic spiritual techniques, like visualization, provided here.*

Now, perhaps at this point you are asking, “Why does visualization work and how do I do it?” As to why, I’ll explain in more detail about the technical aspects of visualization in subsequent books.⁶⁰ For now, the sound bite explanation will have to do, and here it is: energy is really just a “stepped down” form of Consciousness; as such, energy responds, in a direct and literal fashion, to the contents of your consciousness. The bottom line is, if you think about something, then the energy that makes up the universe begins to move in the direction of your thinking. Keep something in your mind long enough, and the energy of creation will eventually manifest your vision. I like to represent this basic principle of creation with my creative catchphrase:

As above in consciousness, so below in matter.

This means that whatever is in your brain (or more technically correct, your consciousness) determines the

⁶⁰Particularly in The Book of Light, all volumes, and The Book of Magic.

universe that you experience; whatever you dream in your consciousness (above) manifests in creation (below); or, *as above, so below* as the hermits like to say—more or less, anyway. Truth is, it is not always as straight forward as that. The truth is, on this Earth, there is always a lot of interference from sleepyheads who think, for whatever reason, that it is okay to actively impose their horrible visions of life, the universe, and everything on others. Under the *creatively hostile* conditions of this planet, even if you have a very clear visualization of what you want (which most of you do not, as yet, have), and even if you have total confidence in that vision (doubtful, considering the spiritually hostile conditions we live under), *you can't always manifest what you want as fast as you want because of all the interference and resistance*. Still, you should not let the difficulty stop you. I am not saying this to discourage you, but to encourage you to take control. Until conditions are not so hostile to your heart's desire, you will simply need to have patience and persistence in order to steer the vehicle and create the world you want. You do not do yourself any favors by backing out of this potential because it is a little difficult, or because it might take longer than you might have imagined at the start. Besides, creative conditions on this Earth will not be hostile forever. *Times are a*

changing and before you know it there will be a lot less resistance to the visions in your head, and a lot more support for the positive, creative, and life affirming activities you want to pursue. It might be frustrating at first, but learning to visualize, learning to steer, will definitely be worth your while in both the short term and the long term. It will be beneficial not only in terms of being able to control the world around you and manifest your desire, it is also critical for your spiritual awakening process! I am not exaggerating when I say that *visualization, like breathing and trust, is one of the keys of rapid and safe spiritual awakening.*

At this point, a word of explanation might be in order. As I have said repeatedly now, “as above in consciousness, so below in matter.” This statement implies that Consciousness has an impact on the physical world, and that is certainly the point behind the admonishment to visualize. When you visualize, Consciousness is directing physical manifestation. But what about your spiritual state? How can visualization, which is Consciousness affecting physical matter, have anything to do with your *spiritual* awakening. Logically, even intuitively, you would think that spiritual awakening is a spiritual process that has little to do with material reality; but. That is not true. The truth is, *spiritual awakening is a physical process, and it is*

governed by all the rules and limitations of the material world.

Allow me to explain.

Your body, your brain, your nervous system, and your mind are all made up of physical matter. Consciousness seats itself in your body it is true, but consciousness refracts through the physical unit like light refracts through a prism! If you change the state of the physical unit, that is, if you drug it, stupefy it (with alcohol, for example), break it, hurt it, heal it, empower it, etc., the quality of the light (i.e. Consciousness) as it is refracted through the prism of your body changes. *Change the state of your physical unit and you change the state of consciousness refracted through the physical unit!* Because visualization effects the physical universe, because your physical unit is a part of the physical universe, and because the state/condition of your physical body impacts consciousness as it is refracted through your body, spirituality is a physical process, and visualization can therefore impact spirituality. Therefore, treat your body/mind like the physical object that it is. If you want your body to be healthy,⁶¹ visualize a healthy body (and do not forget to eat right and

⁶¹Especially in this toxic post-industrial soup we call modern city life.

exercise!). If you want your mind to awaken, visualize an awakening mind. If you want to activate your body's energy system, visualize an activating energy system. *If you want to control your spirituality, control your physical body.* Control your physical body and physical mind through visualization just as you would control any other aspect of the physical universe: by deep breathing, persistent intent, and visualization! That is all there is to it.

Now, as great as this basic technique of visualization is (especially when coupled with breathing and intent), there is one problem that we have to surmount before we can efficiently make use of the power of visualization. The problem is simple. Because of what I can only call the “slave training” most of us get in schools, many of us have lost our ability to visualize. That is, because of what we all mistakenly called “education,” our “right brain” capabilities, our visual, metaphoric, and imaginary powers, have atrophied, through no fault of our own, to the point of failure. This makes visualization a problem for a lot of us; but, that is okay. It is a challenge, but it is not impossible to overcome. It is not as if we are permanently damaged. We can regain our ability to visualize any time we want, and we can strengthen it to whatever level we desire, by engaging in some simple right brain activities. There are

many ways to do it, and I am going to list only a few. It is easy and you should start immediately. Use your imagination to come up with other ways, and trust your own intuition about what kind of practice might work best for you. In addition, whatever you do, do not rush it, do not be discouraged, and have faith. As long as you stick with it long enough, the ability to visualize will come back to you. I promise.

So, here is what you do:

- Pick up an adult coloring book
- Pick up a musical instrument and find a good teacher
- Hang out with children
- Study art
- Try creative writing
- Go take dancing lessons
- Do something kinesthetic
- Do something artistic
- Do something creative

Make a pot, paint a picture, write a song, and do not let me hear you whining, “But I do not have any talent” or “I am not good at anything.” It is just not true. Talent is not God-given, and even if you totally suck at something, you will get better with persistent practice. Remember this truth: *talent is the crystallized effect*

and predictable outcome of lifetimes of extended practice. The truth is, Mozart, Beethoven, Galileo, Picasso or any of the other super-talented individuals in this world loved doing “their thing” so much that they were willing to devote lifetimes to it. They were talented not because God gave them a “gift,” but because they had divine-like commitment to their craft. You too can learn to play piano and compose like Mozart if you spend a dozen lifetimes learning music as he did. Of course, most of us do not have that kind of commitment and that is okay. You do not need that kind of commitment and talent to visualize properly or to be excellent at the things you do. You just need to get your right brain energies moving again. You just need to do a little practice, and you need to learn (or re-learn) to visualize. So, get some right brain practice, and while you are at it, practice your ability to visualize. Picture what it is you want in your mind. If you have difficulty, if you cannot do it initially, try again.

If you do have difficulties, I recommend you start simple by visualizing energy flows. Visualize colors in the air, energy patterns in your room, or chakra activations if you feel so inclined. Then, move to simple geometrics (i.e., boxes and stuff). If you have trouble with that, find a real box (like a jewelry box or something), look at it, close your eyes, and try to see it

in your mind's eye. When you look at the box and close your eyes, you should find that the image lingers, even if only briefly. When the image fades, do it again, and again, and again until your ability to visualize builds up. Consider this an exercise and practice it often with boxes, flowers, pens, or with anything you happen to have to hand. If you have initial difficulty, do not be discouraged—stick at it. Keep up with the right brain activities (music, art, etc.), keep practicing your visualization, and eventually your mind's ability to visualize and imagine will come back to you. As it does, do not be afraid!⁶² Joyfully embrace the power to visualize. Know that it is the joy that you add to the process that will speed your awakening along at lightning speed.

As a final practical technique, you may also want to try having an internal dialogue with yourself. That is, talk to yourself. Talking to your self is a great way to enhance right brain activity. All children do it. Indeed, many children go so far as to have imaginary friends. Of

⁶²If you do find yourself getting “scary” images and thoughts, just push them away. Get rid of them. **Do not dwell on them!** If you dwell on them, you will be giving them more and more reality, so just push them away. I recommend you give those nasty thoughts and dark images a good swift and solid kick in the behind as you shove them, with due haste, out the front door. Do not argue with them; just get rid of them as soon as they pop up. That is the way.

course, as adults we find this creative ability beaten out of us. The attack on your wise, intuitive, spiritually connected right hemisphere starts with gusto around the age of eight, and culminates in the total imaginary vacuum of the “normal” adult. Still, it is like riding a bike. Just because it is forgotten does not mean it is gone. Take steps to recapture the imaginative innocence of childhood. It will pay off in your life in ways that you cannot yet imagine.

One final comment: if it takes you a while to get this right, do not worry. Recapturing your full ability to visualize is not a requirement of awakening. Breathing is critical, trust is critical, but visualization is not. As long as you breathe correctly and can summon trust, and as long as you do not resist, you will be carried along in the rising tide of awakening as it occurs on this planet. Truth is, nobody can stay asleep much longer, so you are going to wake up no matter whether you learn to visualize or not. However, you will find the process easier and more pleasant, and you will not have to wait for “the tide,” if you take firm control early on and visualize exactly how you want your awakening (and the awakening of those around you) to happen..

Beyond that, I have said it before, and I will say it again, trust, intend, and imagine! Start now, practice often, and always remember this:

As above in consciousness, so below in matter.

The future of your life, and the future of this world, is contained in the images and ideas in your brain. *Trust yourself, breathe, visualize, and manifest.* Take control of those images and ideas and create a better world for yourself and everyone else. *You have the power and wisdom within you to steer your own course through life, and your own path towards awakening, activation, and ascension.*

Road Safety

*do not underestimate the value of
Doing Nothing, of just going
along, listening to all the things
you can't hear, and not
bothering. ~ Winnie the Pooh*

In the last chapter, we talked about the importance of visualization. There you learned that visualization is quite literally the steering wheel that your immortal spirit uses to steer through the roadways of creation. It is not an exaggeration to say that, all other things being equal, visualization has the potential to determine the things that manifest in your life and the direction your life is going. If you want something to happen, or not to happen for that matter, then put a nice detailed visualization of it in your head and intend. When you do, the energy of the universe begins to flow into the vision you have in your head and the work of manifesting that vision begins. Simple! There is nothing difficult or mystically complicated about this process! Really, this is magical “grade school” stuff that should be taught to all of us as part of our school curriculum.

In this chapter, I want to move beyond breathing, intent (i.e., the things that get your car/body started), and visualization (steering) to talk more about what you have to do to stay safe on the road. Spiritual road safety is an important topic. It is important for exactly the same reasons that regular road safety is important. When you get behind the wheel of that car that you drive, you have to remember, you are not the only driver on the road. When you drive your car, you have to drive responsibly. You have to avoid bumping into things and you have to drive defensively to prevent others (who may not be paying attention, may be sleeping at the wheel, may be drunk, or otherwise operating with diminished capacity, etc.) from bumping into you and causing you bodily harm. It is the same when you get into your body/vehicle. When your Consciousness steps into the body/vehicle, fires it up, and gets it rolling, you have to try to avoid the bumps. Not only that, you have to remember, you are not the only one on the road. Not only do you have to drive safely to ensure you are not hurting others, but, because you never can tell the “state of consciousness” of the other drivers on the road with you, you have to drive defensively to avoid any bumps from others who may be still sleeping at the wheel.

So how do you drive safely and defensively while your Spirit is driving around in your physical body? As with all things spiritual, it involves ideas. Remember the sacred principle I introduced earlier, *as above in consciousness, so below in matter*. We use this principle to remind ourselves that what we think affects the world around us, including our bodies. It is an important spiritual principle to remember. Energy follows thought. Visualize something, and the energies move to make it so. xxx

As we learned in the last chapter, we visualize and intend in order to drive our physical vehicle (our physical unit) around. But, as we fire up our vehicles, and later as we turbo charge them, we also need to understand that *the ideas that we have in our head, the visions that we have in our mind that we use to direct our vehicle through life, affects the world of others as well as our own*. “No man [sic] is an island,” as John Donne said. If you have negative thoughts about your neighbors, for example, or if you go around wishing that your enemies get hurt, you are giving energy to the manifestation of these ideas and *increasing the probability* of their occurrence. The truth is, if we give enough energy to ideas, and there are no counteracting influences, the ideas eventually manifest in one form or another. If these ideas are negative ideas that intend

harm on others, then, in effect, you are using your soul's physical vehicle to bump others around on the road, and you should not normally do that. Bumping others around with the thoughts in your mind is not "safe driving" and it is not good road etiquette, so if you are doing it, stop. It is not hard to stop. If you want to stop bumping others around on the road, just stop thinking bad thoughts about them—that is all. You do not have to go around loving everybody if you do not want to. No flower power or granola eating is necessary here. It is okay to not like someone; but if you do not like them, do not think about them, period. Just push them out of your consciousness, put them out of your space, and do not consider them at all. That is all you have to do. If you do that, you'll be following good spiritual road etiquette and you will avoid mucking up the driving experience of others.

Now, of course, driving is always a two-way street. That is, there are always others on the road with you. A good driver recognizes this fact, takes it into account, and drives defensively. I mean, you can never tell the "state" of the drivers around you, right? It would be great if the other people on the road would follow good road etiquette, drive safely, and not muck around with your driving experience, but you just never know. Unfortunately, while most of the people on this Earth

stay sleeping, you cannot really trust others to be polite drivers. For one thing, many people still do not have a clue about *as above in consciousness, so below in matter* and so would not think twice about having (sometimes extremely) negative thoughts about you. For another, *your friends, family, co-workers, colleagues, and even your older kids can really put a monkey wrench in your driving plans when they are not thinking and controlling their own negativity.* As Christ said, you cannot blame them, because they do not know better. However, at the same time, as you navigate the awakening process, you want to stay mostly out of their way to avoid any unfortunate bumps or crashes. It is just wise to drive defensively.

Now, it is important to be aware, it is not just the people you normally drive around with that you have to worry about. People on the opposite side of the world can have ideas about you that have a profound impact on your driving experience as well. This works at the personal, national, and international levels. I certainly would not want to be living in a nation that everyone else is coming to hate and fear. You just know that in conditions like that, and according to the principle *as above in consciousness, so below in matter*, sooner or later all that negativity is going to lead to a bump or

two.⁶³ For example, and as you know, there are people out there who actually believe in evil. There are also people who believe in moralistic sin. There are even people who believe in divinely sanctioned hierarchy, poverty, and war. Heck, there are people who think that during the “end times,” God is going to come flashing down in order to rain fiery death and destruction on the unworthy of this Earth. It is absurd, for sure, but people believe it anyway. In fact, many people believe it. Indeed, enough people on this Earth currently believe in that nonsense to manifest it, at least in part. Now, I do not know about you, but I do not want to be on the same road as they when they manifest that nonsense. In fact, I want my family and I to avoid that energy altogether. Frankly, I do not want to have anything to do with it, and good news, I do not have to. The truth is, barring carelessness or accident, I can work to, if not totally avoid that stuff, at least lower the probability of

⁶³Social class and gender of course figure in here. Upper classes work very hard to protect themselves financially and physically from threats of this nature. Crap tends to travel downhill, so when bad things happen because of collective negativity, it is generally the people at the bottom that suffer. There’s a horrible irony here because it is generally the rich and powerful who are responsible for the violence and exploitation that creates the hatred of country that generates the negative energy. However, they rarely suffer the full extent of the energetic backlash because they have the money, the power, and the expertise to protect themselves from the consequences of their own exploitative actions.

experiencing it. I can avoid the negativity of my friends and family who do not know better, the hatred of my enemies who are out to get me (even if only in their thoughts), and even the crazy ideas people have about the way the universe works if I just build a little energy field around my body, my immediate family (or at least those I want in my space), my home, my workspace, and so on.

Building this energy field is very easy to do. To do it, to block out the little black energetic “slings and arrows” that people send at you intentionally or inadvertently with their gray and black thought patterns, simply visualize a white ball of energy, a halo of light, surrounding your body about five inches away from your skin. Visualize it now; visualize it often! For best results, *keep in mind the following ideas while you do it.*

- The halo that you create by visualizing is an impenetrable energetic barrier of light. Its purpose is to allow positive and life-affirming energies in and to keep all negative energies (no matter where they come from) away from you and the ones you choose to protect.
- Nothing that is harmful to you or the ones you love gets in. Everything that is supporting to

you and uplifting of your creative spaces, passes through unhindered.

Visualize and intend this barrier every day, several times a day, in the morning, afternoon, and evening. From this day forward, do not ever forget about doing it. Considering how many people there are out there with weird ideas and negative thought patterns, it is wise to spend some time each day building up and strengthening your barrier.

There are a couple of things you can do to strengthen your barrier. For one thing, you can strengthen the protective action of the barrier by simply visualizing the protective action. See little black energy streams, like little black thought arrows, bouncing off the barrier of light without any effect.⁶⁴ You can strengthen the barrier by visualizing larger and larger arrows bouncing off with impotent effect. And, do not stop there either. Visualize the opposite action as well. Visualize white thought arrows (i.e. positive and supportive thoughts and energies) penetrating the barrier in order to strengthen the reality you choose to manifest. You can

⁶⁴You can, if you like, and especially if you get tired of all the little black slings and arrows sent by others, visualize the little black arrows fizzling away as they smash into the white light barrier. If you do this, make sure you are aware of the implications of this variation.

build those up over time as well. Just visualize larger and larger white arrows penetrating in and supporting your world. It is that easy. Combine these two visualization strategies into an effective and powerful safety mechanism and you will be amazed at the results.

Another way to strengthen the action of the barrier is to actually build it up. To do that, simply take a deep breath and, as you exhale, see little sparkling white energy nodules floating around your protective barrier, and entering into your halo. Breathe in and draw the infinite, wispy tendrils of white energy that surround your body into the halo that you create. As the energy enters, see how the halo strengthens. As you add energy, the halo goes from a pale and translucent white to a thick and solid barrier of energy. Keep building this barrier up by adding energy to it over days and weeks. When you are satisfied it is strong enough to protect you, begin to expand it away from your body to include your close family, your house, your car, your work, and anything else that you want to preserve and keep safe from the weird ideas and negativity of others. Go as far as you want with this. Expand this barrier as wide and as thick as you care to. Keep in mind that there is no limit on how strong the barrier can be. If you want my advice, given current conditions of this world, the stronger you make that barrier, the better.

The exercise is worthwhile. More important, *do not let up on this barrier until either the world is a much better place or you are absolutely certain of the power of your own divinity and therefore absolutely convinced of your immunity from negativity.* My advice is, keep this barrier in mind, and teach this ritual to others, for at least the next 20 years, maybe a bit more. I figure it will be at least 20 years until enough people have awakened and put aside the crazy ideas and unthinking negativity of their daily round to make it safe to go about in this world “unprotected.” Until that day comes, do the visualization daily and protect yourself while you are on the road.

I would like to make one final comment before closing this section. When you build this barrier, when you build the halo and expand it into a wall that protects your entire life space, you are going to find that things change in your life. Relationships especially are going to rearrange themselves in sometimes subtle and sometimes dramatic ways. For example, as you do the protection ritual, you may find that people whom you never would have thought had any negative intent towards you suddenly become distant. Depending on negotiations at the soul level, and the level of discomfort that these negative influences feel from being around you, they may even bump right out of

your life temporarily (while they learn to be less negative or learn to release some of the silly ideas they carry around) or permanently (if they refuse to change). You may even find that some of your closest friends and family members are suddenly too busy to spend time with you. If that happens, do not be surprised. Furthermore, keep in mind the purpose of the protection ritual. Remember, the ritual is designed to give you the protected space you need in order to initiate and carry forward your spiritual awakening and activation process. In other words, you are doing this for self-preservation, so do not be freaked out by the change. Remember, you initiated the process for your benefit and you have control. If you want, you can always allow these negative people back into your space once you get control of your own awakening process. When you feel comfortable, invite them back in a superficial “Hi, how are ya, how’s the weather” sort of way. However, make a reasoned decision. *Never forget that these people left your space because of unconscious (or conscious) negativity.* Keep in mind, because they are sleeping, they can be unpredictable and even dangerous. Be aware, individually and collectively, we are running out of time. Therefore, your awakening and activation should be a priority. *do not sacrifice your own forward movement just because you*

feel sorry for somebody else who is stuck in the mud. If you do that then, at the end of the day, you will be as dead as they.

If the loss of people in your life bothers you too much, keep in mind that the shifting relationships are not necessarily permanent. Everybody eventually has to wake up so as long as something bad does not happen to the sleepy heads while they sleep (accidents, cancer, voluntary exits, things like that), they'll probably come back into your life, only at a deeper and more resonant level, a little later. Be open to that possibility. In other words, do not keep the boundaries so rigid that you permanently exclude them, no matter how negative or weird they might have been (unless of course you want to have nothing to do with certain people, then by all means make the barrier permanent). In fact, if you want, you can actually help them wake up. Encourage change and awakening in them by visualizing the same process of waking up that you do (for example, visualize light streaming into their body). **A word of warning though:** when it comes to helping others awaken, do not push too hard. More importantly, do not push at all if you cannot see what is going on in their life or how they are reacting. It is fine to help others awaken by visualizing forward progress for them, but if you push people in a direction they are not ready

to go, they will resist, sometimes aggressively and violently. The truth is, you can do damage to them or others (like their children, their spouses) if they react aggressively. You want to avoid that under all circumstances. It is not right when others interfere with your own life plans; it is even less acceptable for someone who is “in the know” to interfere with the life paths of others. The more you know, the more you must take care of others.

A final word before closing: *if you find yourself in the role of parent or protector of others who are weak, innocent, or in need of defense, adopt a no-compromise approach.* Children must be protected at all costs. In these cases, do not think about yourself; stand your ground and keep the barriers strong no matter what. If it is just you, if you are by yourself, it may be okay to allow some degree of negativity into your space. You may be able to handle it. You may know what to do. However, you are not doing yourself, your children, or anyone else you are responsible for any favors by allowing the negativity into their life. As a parent, it is your job to protect your children and prevent them from coming to any harm whatsoever. Take the job seriously. If you are protecting others, especially the children being born these days, no compromise is appropriate. I cannot say this enough. *When there are*

little ones involved, get the negativity away and keep it away, period.

Build the barrier.

Keep it strong.

Roadside Communication

People who do not think probably do not have Brains; rather, they have gray fluff that's blown into their heads by mistake. ~ Winnie the Pooh

At this point in this book we have come a long way and talked about many important concepts and techniques, all of which are necessary for awakening, activation, and proper operation of your physical vehicle. We have looked at things like trust, breathing, visualization, intent, and protection rituals. With these things rehearsed and part of our daily practice, it is time to consider opening up a channel of communication to the spirit world. Specifically, it is time to think about opening a channel of communication to your **Guide Network**.⁶⁵

And just what is your guide network? Well, your guide network is a tight collection of *disincarnate* spiritual entities who are here to assist you to awaken and activate, and who want nothing more than to hover

⁶⁵https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Guide_Network

around and provide you with the energetic support services you need to complete your chosen work. In other words, your guide network is here to help you and uplift you. That is all.

Now, a lot of people have the mistaken idea that their guides are like *teachers* or *directors* whose job is to **direct** you through life and tell you what to do. However, that's not the way it is. Your Spirit guides are not more knowledgeable than you, more spiritual than you, more wise than you, or more "good" than you. Truth be told, it is exactly the opposite. You are the one with the knowledge and the experience. You are the one who is at the front line. You are the one who is literally in the driver's seat. You are in a body; you are looking at the world with your eyes; you are experiencing creation with your senses; **you are the one living in the physical universe.** *Because you are the one with direct experience of the material world, your guides cannot sensibly direct you better than you can direct yourself.* It does not make any sense. Letting your guides direct you as if they had all the knowledge, wisdom, and answers would be like allowing a landlubber who's never been in a boat tell an experienced sea-faring captain how to pilot the ship, with a cellphone, from a thousand miles away. Clearly, that is crazy, and so it is with your guides. Because you are in the driver's seat,

your guides cannot direct you more sensibly than you can direct yourself. Really, your guides are more like disincarnate friends and family members who offer you energetic assistance, and if you want it, gentle and supportive guidance and advice—but only if you ask. And let me be clear here, if you want your guides to help, you need to ask them. Not only will your guides *never* make a decision for you, they will also *never* do anything to you without your permission. You are in total control. You are, quite literally, the captain of your ship. As I explain in the “Parable of the Garden” (included in the appendix of this book), your spiritual guides are there to help you first find your way out of the darkness of this Earth, and second to help you do the job that you came here to do.

Now, I’ve got to say that, in all cases, your guides are very good at providing you with assistance. If you ask them for advice, chances are they have good advice and good suggestions, and that’s not because they are smarter than you, it is just because they know you well. In fact, because your consciousness is “veiled,” i.e., because you have been wearing what I call **the blindfold**,⁶⁶ your guides know you and the purpose for which you incarnated better than you yourself do, *at the*

⁶⁶https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/The_Blindfold

start. In fact, when it comes to the whys, wherefores, and “where am I going” type questions, your guides have the answer, at least initially; but remember this, your guides are only more knowledgeable than you *at the start*, when you are still wearing the blindfold, or struggling to take it off and keep it off. Once you get your own bearings and get moving, your guides are only there for energetic assistance. Also, keep in mind, your guides are not babysitters and they won’t stick around you forever. They are just there to help you through the first stages of your awakening process. Once you have it under control, your guides are no longer needed, and they will step back in order that you can make your own decisions, and set your own course, and that’s a good thing. It is something to shoot for. *You want to get to a point where you are clear about your identity and purpose, and confident enough in your own abilities, to pilot without advice.* It should not take too long to get there, but until you get there, trust your guides. Your guides are there to ensure a safe awakening.

With guides put in their proper place the question now becomes, how do you contact your guides? How do you open a channel of communication to them? Like all things spiritual, it is very easy. *All you have to do to open a channel to your guide network is visualize a connection of some sort.* The easiest, and therefore

most powerful, visualization that I can think of is to visualize an “energy pipe” starting from your brain center and passing through your skull up into the spiritual world. Simply see a tube exiting your skull. See the pipe as it exits your skull widen and expand into a huge cosmic funnel where energy flows. Then, see the cosmic energy flowing into your physical unit through a narrow “point of contact” into your skull. From there the energy/information flows into your brain and central nervous system (CNS). Focus in on the energy and notice how it enlivens your entire nervous system. As the energy enters, your brain lights up, your nerves sparkle with energy, and your body glows with the light and power flowing through you. Now, as you visualize this scene in your head, notice how you control the flow of energy. You can squeeze the energy flow and cut yourself off from the funnel that connects you to the Fabric of Consciousness or you can speed up the energy flow and even expand the funnel at the top to encompass the entire universe and beyond. There is no limit to how wide that funnel can become, and no external control over the process. You turn the spigot on or off. You specify the energy flow. You control how wide or narrow the channel is.

Most of you reading these words will have a closed-off channel of communication. do not feel bad, it is not

your fault. As adults, we end up like that (i.e. disconnected). We do not start that way as children. Oh, no! As children, we have a wide-open channel to the Fabric. However, for reasons I outline throughout my writings, as we grow into teenagers and adults, for various reasons (like fear, misconception, and outright deception) we close that channel. We are taught, for example, that we are tiny, irrelevant, and insignificant nothings against the power and glory of “God.” *Our feelings of insignificance cause us to shut down when we face our own power and glory.* Or, we are taught that the spiritual realms are filled with demons, devils, and tricksters of every kind. In this case, *we close the connection out of fear of the “dark side.”* If it is not insignificance and fear, it is judgment. Often we are taught that judgment awaits us “on the other side,” and who wants to be judged after all? To avoid judgment, we shut the connection. Finally, if we come from a more scientific background, we are taught that to hear “voices” or to have “experiences” may be a sign of madness. If we hear voices, our own confusion, and the confusion and misunderstanding of the medical establishment ensures a horrible denouement to any nascent connection we may experience. The truth is, we are taught all sorts of silliness about spirituality and the *Fabric* and so we close off our connection out of fear,

insecurity, anxiety, and ignorance. We put up a wall, build a meniscus, and shut down the connection. We then put on this big show for ourselves and everybody else about how we do not understand and we cannot connect and we do not have the power and oh gosh, and oh darn, gee, golly whiz.

Ah but dear *chela*, here is the rub. No matter what you might have been told, no matter what fears or misconceptions you may harbor, you do have the power to open. You have total authority over the channel. All you have to do to open a channel is clear misconception, get over your fear, put aside nonsense about judgment, and trust in your own ability to control the channel. Then, when you have cleared the way, open a channel by visualizing a pipe. When you do that, the channel is instantly opened. It may take a short tie for information to begin to flow, and it may take a bit of time for you to open to it and recognize when it comes, but the channel is open immediately, and information should start to flow shortly.

Now, as strange as this might sound to some of you, and although I have given you a lot of tools and advice in this book to prepare you for opening a channel, I would not recommend blasting the skull pipe open just yet. My advice, no matter who you are and what types

of communication you may have had in the past, is to start slow. Remember what I have said. The reality on the other side of the meniscus is vast and mind boggling and even with proper breathing, clear intent, focused visualization, protection rituals, and the safe driving lessons provided earlier, you still want to proceed with caution.⁶⁷ Open a little bitty pipe at first and allow just a thin sliver of energy to pass back and forth. do not overdo it, but do it like you do all the other visualizations you do. Do it for a few seconds, whenever you think about it, several times a day, persistently until “things” start happening.

Synchronicity

What kind of things? Since it is a tiny connection at first, you will be looking for “meaningful” or “synchronous” things to happen. For those of you who do not know, *synchronicity, is the occurrence of an extremely unlikely event with deep personal significance and meaning.* A synchronicity is a remarkable, often an astounding “coincidence” that is unmistakably personal, deeply meaningful, and outrageously cosmic in its statistical improbability. The “event,” the synchronicity, could be anything: it could

⁶⁷In other words, stay away from stronger connections for a while.

be something your neighbor says; it could be some weird and inexplicable electronic malfunction; it could be a vehicle driving in front of you with a special message on the license plates; it could be a beggar on the street approaching; it could be a number flashing repeatedly before you.⁶⁸ Really, the synchronicity could be anything under the sun so long as it has personal meaning and is outrageously improbable. When you experience a synchronicity, you will just know that “something” is going on and/or someone is trying to talk to you.

When you open a channel to the Fabric, synchronicity is the first evidence/sign of communication with your guides. Synchronicity is the first channel that your guide network will use to communicate with you. Indeed, when you open your skull pipe up just a little bit, it is the only form of communicating they can use. So if you are coming at this with no previous experience, and if you are just starting out, pay attention! Your first communications with your guide network will likely be in the form of synchronicity.

Now, synchronicity is an okay kind of communication channel to use and there are a couple of positive features to it. **For one**, synchronicity *is* a form of

⁶⁸11:11 anyone?

spiritual communication and so your guide network can get a message to you without much ambiguity⁶⁹ **Two**, the impersonal nature of synchronicity keeps a nice safe boundary between your ego and the rest of the Spirit world. Keeping a solid boundary between your ego and the spirit world is a good thing, especially in the beginning when you may be a little naïve, and when fears, misconceptions, and uncertainties might undermine your connection, and darken your experience. When synchronicity is in play, you can get a communication from Spirit without invoking misconceptions, dealing with uncertainties, or confronting fears. Put another way, *synchronicity is a good starting point because it allows the sleeping/unprepared mind of the body, the mind that is unfamiliar with the deep realities of Spirit, to see that something big is going on without becoming terrified by the implications.* Synchronicity is a slow dose of communication meted out in safe measure designed to ensure the integrity of the ego. xxx

There are some positive aspects to synchronicity, that is for sure, but there are a couple of negative aspects as well. **First off**, although you can always tell that something is “going on” when you catch a synchronous

⁶⁹Given the statistical improbability of the synchronicity, it cannot be rationally denied.

message, that's often all you can tell. Owing to the difficulty of arranging material events in an improbable but meaningful sort of way, the message sent to you is *always* a simple message, and *often* merely an empty message—meaning that the only meaning to be found is in the fact that the event is meaningful. That's okay at the start when the idea is usually just to get your attention and prove to you that there is more to life than meets the eye, but in the long run it is a huge limitation. There is a lot more to spiritual communication than flashy, but thin, synchronicities. Once you get used to the idea of communicating with Spirit through synchronicities, once you are comfortable that there is something going on beneath the meniscus, you have to move on to deeper, more connected forms of spiritual communication.

Synchronicity happens a lot in your life, a lot more than you realize, especially these days. In fact, it is often the case these days that those in the spirit world who have an interest in you (i.e. members of your *guide network*) have some kind of “life or death” message to get through to you. Unfortunately, until we actually start to pay attention, we tend to miss many of the “desperate” messages our *guide network* tries to send us. This is because, and this is the **second weakness**, although a synchronous event is easy to see if you are paying

attention, because of the subtle nature of the event, it is also easy to miss if you aren't looking. The moral here is, *pay attention*.

A **third problem** with synchronicity is that it takes a lot of effort. Synchronicity is okay for what it is, but amongst all the methods of getting a message through the meniscus, synchronicity is the most “primitive,” most indirect, most difficult form of communication that can happen. Owing to the “viscous” nature of physical reality, it takes your guide network immense concentration and intent to arrange even the simplest events. If you hang on to synchronicity and depend on it too long, you are asking a lot from your guides. I can tell you now, they won't carry on banging their heads against your stubborn refusal to “see” forever. If you do not move on to easier and more effective forms of spiritual communication, they will stop trying. When that happens, you have either got to wait for them to chill enough to want to try and get a message through again, or you are going to have to move on to an easier (for them) form of communicating. You can't ask them to keep doing it for you forever. It is too much work and they will eventually give up. My advice to you here is, trust your own eyes. If the event seems impossible within the rational confines of a materialist universe, it

is. Learn the lesson (i.e. there is something more going on) and move on.

Finally, it also important to note that synchronicity is something you can control. You do not have to stand around waiting for your guide network to send you a message. You can trigger synchronicities by simply asking your guides meaningful questions. Ask a question and wait 24 to 48 hours for the answer. I recommend a simple question like “Are you there?” or “Who am I?” or “Show me a sign that I cannot deny,” or something like that. Keep an open mind too. The answer you get, especially to the “Who am I?” question, may surprise you.

Emotive Communication

Once you get the message that there is something more going on beneath the surface of this reality that at first meets the physical eye, and presuming you do not get freaked out and fearful, then the next step is to open the skull pipe a little wider. You already know how to do that. To do it, simply visualize the narrow pipe widening a bit. How much should you widen the pipe? Trust your intuition. A little bit or a lot, it is up to you. Of course, once you decide how much, then you do it like you do all the visualizations you do. Visualize for a

few moments, persistently and faithfully, several times a day, until “things” start happening.

What kinds of things? Well, feeling things, emotional things, and bodily things. When you open the skull pipe a little wider, start paying attention to your body and its responses, because *external spiritual influence on your actual physical body* (i.e. spiritual manipulation of the subtle systems of your body) *is the next step in opening a full channel to the spiritual world.*

Perhaps at this point you are asking yourself, “How can a disincarnate spirit influence my physical body?” Well, when you are willingly open to the influence or when you are not aware of your absolute spiritual sovereignty and therefore “open by mistake,” it is easy. In fact, the same high spiritual principle that governs the interaction of consciousness with the physical universe operates here as well.

*As above in consciousness,
So below in matter.*

In other words, just as you influence the physical world through the thoughts you have in your head, and just as disincarnated Spirit can communicate with you by influencing the external material world through synchronicity, Spirit (whether in a body or not) can

influence your body as well because it is an aspect of the physical world. *Your body and mind are part of the material world and like all aspects of the material world, your body (and mind) respond to Consciousness pure and simple.*

Using your body to get a message through to you is a better form of communication than synchronicity. **The primary benefit** is *that communicating through your body is a lot easier than communicating through synchronicity.* Indeed, all Immortal Spirit has to do to communicate in this fashion is influence (or caress) your body in a way that is noticeable to you. Typically, Spirit targets your CNS in order to provide you with some kind of sensation. What kind of sensation depends on the message that Spirit is trying to convey. If it is a happy message that everything is okay and you can keep going on your merry way, then you will have happy sensations. Spirit will caress the emotional and psychological systems of your body and you will feel good. The good feelings could be anything from tingly “resonations”⁷⁰ to feelings of well-being and self-

⁷⁰An 18th century Christian mystic and scientist by the name of Emanuel Swedenborg noted the reality and significance of these “emotive communications.” He called them “signs” and said that he felt “assured his thoughts were on the right track when he experienced what he called “a sign”:...a certain cheering light and joyful flash...that darts through some sacred temple of the brain”

satisfaction.⁷¹ *If you are moving forward, acting in alignment, and safe from external danger, you will feel happy, safe, content, and satisfied.* On the other hand, if things are not ok, if you are acting out of alignment or moving in the wrong direction, or if Spirit is urgently trying to get a message to you like “WAKE UP, WAKE UP YOU ARE GOING TO CRASH,” then the spiritual caress will bring more urgent/unhappy sensations. The urgent sensations could be anything from worry through shame, guilt, malaise, and even foreboding. It really just depends, so pay attention to your feelings because you never know who might be trying to talk to you.

Another benefit of using your body to communicate is that the quality of the message is better than what you can get with synchronicity. *Synchronicity is a blunt hammer compared to the subtle possibilities that open when you enable bodily communication through your CNS.* It is not that much better than synchronicity, mind you. Relying on the emotions and sensations of

George F. Dole and Robert H. Kirven, *A Scientist Explores Spirit: A Biography of Emanuel Swedenborg* (Pennsylvania: Chrysalis books, 1997) 34.

⁷¹There is nothing, and when I say nothing I mean nothing, wrong with being satisfied with your self. In fact, that is something to aspire to.

the physical body really only give you a binary good/bad sort of communication, but it is still better than synchronicity because even with that binary communication you get more information through. It is not perfect, and its better when combined with sixth sense communicating (see below), or even open channeling, but it is still more useful than synchronicity

A final benefit of emotive communication is that like synchronicity, it is also safe for the *bodily ego*. If you are still a little frightened by the depths beneath the surface, if you still harbor scientific prejudice, if you still have many “wrong ideas” about what it is like “on the other side” (ideas that might make it psychologically or emotionally risky to attempt full connection), you still maintain a relatively strong **Ego Boundary**. In line with the maintenance of an ego boundary, this method of communication is also safe for you and your worldview as well. If you decide you do not want to go any further, or that this is all a bunch of spiritual hooey, you can easily dismiss synchronicity and the emotional caress of spirit as random nothingness, or your own body acting on its own. In other words, *this is still a point of return*. At this point, you do not have to confront or commit to the notion of deeper spiritual realities at all. You are still free to shut

down and return to normal if that is what you decide to do.

As with other basic forms of spiritual communication, emotive communications has its weaknesses as well. Like synchronicity, the ability to transfer ideas and meaning is limited. As noted above, with emotive communication there is a bit more potential, but you are still dealing with a relatively limited range of good/bad emotive responses. This limited range does not allow the communication of complex ideas and expressions. Also, as with synchronicity, the communicating is not direct. You do something, guides tweak your CNS, and you feel good or bad. Because we generally do many different things during the day, and because the communication is indirect, it is very easy to confuse the meaning of the communication, or miss it altogether. Still, emotive communication is better than synchronicity and even when you move onto to better forms, it remains a useful communication tool. For example, my higher self still uses my body's emotions to issue me certain alerts and warning. Also, even though I consider myself an advanced spiritual communicator, I still feel bad (i.e. I still feel guilt, shame, etc.) when I screw up, and I still feel good when I am on the right track.

Obviously, because of the limitations of CNS communication, you do not want to rely on emotive communication for very long, although you can if you want to. Unlike synchronicity, your guide network does not find it tiresome to communicate through your CNS system and so they will continue to press a message until they finally get it through. If you are stubborn and you want to just dig in and stay where you are, you can go on for decades missing/ignoring communication and feeling bad about yourself and your life. Still, you do not want to do that. There is a lot more to spirituality than synchronicity and emotive response and if you do not move past those, yours is only a thin spirituality. My advice to you is, do not get hung up on emotive communications. Accept it, get used to it, listen to it, act on it (i.e. use the messages to move yourself towards alignment), and then move on.

“Sixth-Sense” Communications

Once you are comfortable with the notion that other beings can influence your body, once you get the idea that the boundary between you and “everything else” isn’t a solid wall like you were raised to think, and once you are convinced that this is okay and nothing bad is

going to happen to you because of it,⁷² move on and expand the pipe a bit more. Do it almost exactly like you did it the last time, only this time extend the funnel of energies down through your brain and also out the middle of your forehead. Visualize a funnel of energy sticking out of the top of your head, and a funnel of energy sticking out of the spot just above and between your eyes. Visualize these two pipes as wide or as narrow as you want, and visualize as much energy flowing through them as you like. *The wider the funnel, and the more intense the flow, the faster the development will occur.* Trust your intuition as to how wide to make the pipe, and how much energy to let flow through. When you get a feeling about it, start the visualization. Once again, do it like you do all the visualizations. Do it for a few moments whenever you think about it, several times a day. Be persistent and insistent and do it until intuition, sixth sense, telepathic, and possibly even clairvoyant “things” begin to happen. It will happen, just stick with it and have faith.

I know it might sound like a bit of a stretch to think that telepathic, sixth sense, and clairvoyant things might start happening to you, especially if you have

⁷²TThat is, you do not believe in silly things like demonic possession, madness, or things like that.

lived your life in a locked-down, left brain dominant, hyper-rational mode, but they do happen. Of course, it is not like they present it in Hollywood with flashes, bangs, and divine wrath for tapping into demonic realms. In real life, it is usually more subtle, and easy to miss, especially in the early stages.⁷³ Be mindful, as they say in Buddhism, and pay attention. Until you have developed sensitivity, the communications will not be much more than whispers (e.g. a sick feeling in your gut (your solar chakra) that something is wrong with the person in front of you), or a seemingly random idea floating by you in the stream of your body's consciousness. Open the funnel, encourage ideas and

⁷³To catch the subtlety, do not quiet the mind like the transcendentalists say, instead quiet your environment. Quieting the mind does nothing but still the chatter of the left-brain so you gaze at the immature and often empty right. Quieting the mind in order to have a "mystical" experience is like asking your spouse to shut up while expecting them to tell you a story about their day. You can worship the awareness that you are able to achieve in the silence all you want, but the awareness you achieve is empty, void, and useless all the same, no matter how you want to slick it up with fancy words (like *Pure Conscious Event*). See for example Robert K. Forman, *Mysticism, Mind, and Consciousness*.

images to flow, but calm your environment, otherwise you will miss them. *Create spaces and conditions where you can pay closer attention to the thoughts, feelings, and sensations so that you can actually hear the subtle whispers coming from the stream of consciousness.*

Of course, as with synchronicity and emotive communications, sixth-sense communications have strengths and weaknesses. The biggest strength is that sixth-sense communications potentially carry much more information than more basic forms of spiritual communication (like synchronicity and emotive caresses). Ideas, images, and, under certain conditions, vast cosmic visions can bubble up. The biggest weakness is that often the ideas and images are easy to miss and dismiss. This is especially true when ideas float down the lazy river of an undisciplined mental apparatus, but it is also generally true. We are taught that our consciousness emerges from our brain and is therefore separate and isolated from the consciousness of others. Because we assume that all men and women are islands, we do not brook the notion that the thoughts that pass through our brain may come from outside our little isolation bubble, and hence we do not attempt to distinguish our thoughts from the thoughts of others that might penetrate our little isolation bubble. If we do not think it is a possibility, and it is not

something we pay attention to, we easily miss it even when it is happening. However, we should not do that. Therefore, *in addition to calming our environments, we must pay attention (be mindful as the Buddhists say) to our thoughts*. If you want to make forward spiritual progress, get these ideas into your head, and keep them there.

So far in this chapter we have discussed basic forms of spiritual roadside communication including synchronicity, emotive communications, sixth-sense intuitions, and the like. There are more advanced types of communication, specifically direct and open connection to The Fabric, or *channeling* as it is often called, but I am not going to go into those here.⁷⁴ **Direct connection** to the Fabric of Consciousness is a very powerful, very visceral, and (when you are ill prepared) potentially very *dangerous* form of communication. You really want to progress a little ways towards awakening, enlightenment, and activation before you start “blowing the doorways of perception,” as Huxley put it, wide open. Even if you think you can handle it, the probability that things can go wrong is high. If

⁷⁴I’ll take a deeper, more critical, look at channeling in Michael Sharp, The Book of Magic, vol. 1, 7 vols. (St Albert, Alberta: Lightning Path Press, unpublished).

things go wrong you can get bumped around, tossed off the path, or even experience (in the worst cases) forms of spiritual psychosis. It really is worthwhile doing the groundwork, increasing your knowledge, and practicing with more basic forms of spiritual communication before you move too far forward.

And please understand, I'm not saying any of this to scare you away. Remember, you were once a fish in the water. My advice to you here is only to be careful and go as slow as you need to be ensure safe forward progress. Owing to all the spiritual misconception, archetypal garbage, and emotional and psychological damage we have incurred because of our toxic growth experiences, opening the channel wide can be quite the paranoid, freaky, soul cracking, discombobulating, and even damaging experience. If you want my advice, under current global conditions, the safest, fastest, most effective way forward is to commit to serious spiritual study. If you do not commit to serious spiritual study you'll waste time spinning your wheels, backslide under the weight of all the toxic BS on this planet, and even go down under the weight of the ideology, propaganda, and nonsense of this still-crazy world.

Finally, **a word to the wise here:** use your discernment. No matter how “connected” you might become, not every idea or image that floats through your brain has some high mystical import. *Some ideas are merely shadows*, random thoughts generated by the electrochemical firing of the brain. *Some ideas simply bubble up from your own unconscious depths*, and these ideas can be good or bad depending on what is buried deep inside. *Some ideas float to you from the angry male next door*. Opening up to communication from the Fabric of Consciousness is very much like stepping into a room with a dozen or two random people. You have to know, in that room of two dozen people, not everybody is going to be worth listening to, not everybody has a clue, and not everybody has your best interests at heart. My advice to you here is simple: *learn to filter out the useless chatter*.

I talk more about the hazards of full-on connection in *The Book of Magic*. Here I’ll just say that you can filter out the useless chatter by using your discernment. If you have an idea, *judge it*. If you find the idea lacking, simply reject it. That’s all you have to do. As I like to tell my kids, just because you have a thought, does not mean you have to think it. As I’ve said before, *winnow the wheat* (the good ideas) from the chaff (the bad ideas). If I were you, I would start practicing that now

because the farther you get in your communication practice, the more important discernment is going to be.

As always, visualization and intention is important. It will help your discernment practice if you state a clear intent. I would suggest something like “I wish to hear only from those who have my highest good, and the highest good of all creation, at heart.” An intent statement like this will help filter communications from negative or misinformed sources. Your “filter statement” won’t be enough, however. If you do not want to get dragged down into the murky depths of channeling stupidity, you will also have to assert logic, common sense, and rational discernment, otherwise who knows how ungrounded and insensible you may become.

Gender

Before moving onto the next chapter, I have one final set of comments. *If you are a male, understand that if you want to get past mere synchronicity and simple intuition to more advanced forms of spiritual communication you are going to have to change your understanding of gender.* It is a bit technical, but basically it has to do with the balance of energy in your

body. It is like this: listening to your emotions, plugging into intuition, and gently expanding your mind into the glorious Fabric of Consciousness, is a very soft, feminine, right brain sort of thing to do. It is not very “objective,” not very “manly,” and not the sort of thing that “tough guys” are able to do.

The reason is simple. Overly rational, overly in control, manly sort of men are dominated by the left hemisphere of their brain. The problem with this is that *spiritual communications, at least in the early, tentative stages of awakening, are soft forms of communication that are easily subverted by a dominant, and dominating, left-brain.* The only way to authentically communicate with spirit is from left hemisphere through right hemisphere and up. If your body is bloated by the domineering energies of male superiority and authority, if your left-brain is pumped up on the Martian steroids of yang energy, your right brain is cut off, diminished, oppressed, and atrophies into an empty, childish state. The right brain hemisphere functions best only when there is lots of yin energy around, and since yin has been erroneously associated with female energies, you need to stop suppressing the female side of you. In other words, open to the soft, feminine side. It is not hard. Even if You are the manliest he-man of the universe, you can still learn to

get in touch with your feminine side if you commit “the heresy” (see next chapter) and admit you have a nurturing, loving, artistic, open, intuitive, emotional, soft feminine side. I do not care how nervous or fidgety you might be here. Male or female, you cannot get very far on your spiritual path of awakening unless you balance the energies.⁷⁵

Thankfully, balancing energies is easy to do. To balance your energies, do what you do with all things physical that you want to control. Simply intend and visualize. Say to yourself “I want to work with balanced energies” and then find a visualization of the balance. The simplest (and therefore the most powerful) way that I’ve found is to use the ancient Chinese Yin/Yang symbol. The Yin/Yang is a perfect representation of the balance of energy, and frankly I cannot think of a better way to visualize the balance of Yin/Yang than to use this symbol. So use it. Picture the Yin/Yang symbol floating and rotating on its side above your head; then visualize the symbol “passing through” your body as it energizes you with balanced energies. Trust your intuition here. See it rotating. see it cleansing, see it



⁷⁵In other words, if you are female, make sure you have a balance of male energies as well.

forcing muck out, see it energizing your cells with balanced energy. See whatever you feel is necessary to move you towards balance, just keep balance in mind, and open yourself to the transformation.

And do not be afraid. When you do this visualization, your behavioral repertoire will expand, but in a good way, and a controlled way. In other words, you are not going to suddenly and mysteriously be drawn to your local gay bars. That is just paranoid, fear-based silliness. We choose our dominant gender expression, or cross expression, because that is where we are comfortable, and that is what we enjoy. Leading a more balanced existence does not mean we stop being who we are. It just means we have more options and more powers available to us, that is all. So chill, open, and relax because balancing your energies will do you a world of emotional and spiritual good.

Heresy

*To the uneducated, an "A" is just
three sticks. ~ Winnie-the-Pooh*

If you want my opinion, no great awakening, no penetration of the meniscus, no unfolding into glorious high Consciousness would be complete (or even possible) without a heresy. Personally, I believe a heresy is necessary for awakening, not so much for the sake of the heresy itself but because approaching the heresy is a kind of “test” of where you are at. This is not a test in the sense that someone else is testing you to detect your worthiness or ability. Not at all. Heresy is a test of your progress forward viewable by you and useful only to you.

What do I mean by this? Well, before you can understand what I am talking about here, you need to understand about sacred truth. A sacred truth is an idea or concept so sacrosanct, authoritative, untouchable, and self-evident that even to question the truth causes people to either dismiss your sanity outright, or consider bodily harm against you. Some examples of sacred “truths” might help. The idea that some patriarchal God created the universe, the idea that

evolution is a mindless, empty process, the idea that women are “naturally” loving and nurturing, or the idea that karma operates to provide a form of universal justice, are all sacred truths that people buy into by the billions. These truths are accepted as spiritual/cosmic common sense without question. Everybody knows these things to be true, and nobody questions their reality.

In this context of sacred truths, a heresy occurs when someone, anyone, openly questions, scoffs at, dismisses, or otherwise desecrates somebody’s sacred truth. A heresy is a big deal, especially in the eyes of the *faithful* who often see a heresy as an abomination, a horror, a sign of irrational stupidity, or a sin in the eyes of God (or Darwin). A heresy can be a scary event for everyone involved, but it is usually most uncomfortable for the person committing the heresy. When someone commits a heresy, their whole life is made extremely difficult, sometimes even impossible, by those who feel the need to “defend” the truth.

These days, people generally do not commit heresy. They used to more often, but witch burnings, inquisitions, social exclusion, ridicule, shunning, and the desolation that comes from losing one’s job for thinking the wrong thoughts puts “the fear” deep inside

all of us, and so now most of us stay well on the side of “compliant” and “believing” when it comes to the sacred truths in our life.

So what exactly does heresy have to do with connecting the two egos? What does it have to do with awakening? Let me put it this way for you. The ability to commit a heresy is a good test of where you are at on your own path back to divinity. A fully conscious, fully awakened individual will know that there is no such thing as a sacred truth. A fully conscious individual will know that Spirit makes all the rules and therefore all the rules can be broken, bent, changed, or discarded at any time whatsoever. Rules do exist of course, but they exist as a result of consensus, because the *locals* (in the cosmic sense) agree the rule makes sense in the context of whatever it is they are trying to do, or because they are useful and necessary for local creative conditions/efforts. Rules are rules and truths are truths it is true, but rules and truth change as the universe unfolds and evolves; therefore, rules and truths can be questioned, modified, and even dismissed. It is simply a part of the way the ‘verse unfolds. Every fully aware, fully conscious, individual will know this to be true.

It is not done willy-nilly of course. Standards, rules, and procedures will change over the course of eons, but

changes *always* represent a move forward and/or a better way of doing things. Rules can be broken and sacred truths discarded, but only for a good reason. Spirit never runs around thrashing, trashing, or debasing creation or experience. Spirit always *uplifts* and *ascends*.⁷⁶ In the cosmic context, change is permanent. Therefore, you can judge how open, ready, and advanced you are by your willingness to commit a heretical thought or act. If you are not stuck in meaningless and dated traditions, if you are open to question and revision, if you can comfortably change your mind about things when the truth of things requires you do so, if you can commit a heresy without fear, you are in a psychological and emotional position where moving forward is easier to do. However, if you are presented with a heresy and you get all fidgety, defensive, offensive, or violent, if you shut down and avoid, you know you have emotional and psychological work to do.

What is a good heresy to test yourself against? Well, it really depends on your social-cultural context, your religious background, the way your parents raised you,

⁷⁶Of course, the same cannot be said of a disconnected and damaged physical unit. A disconnected and damaged does not often work to uplift and ascend. A damaged physical unit often works to hurt and destroy.

whether you have a post-secondary education, and things like that. It is hard to specify or give examples for you without knowing the context of your life. A few hundred years ago, it would have been easier. A few hundred years ago, there was a lot more homogeneity in belief systems, so we all tended to agree that certain things were heretical. Nowadays there is much less agreement. What is heresy to a scientist⁷⁷ will not be heresy to a dogmatic Christian, and vice versa. If you are not sure about your own state of openness, ask your Spirit guides to present you with a heresy and then pay attention. I am sure something will come up. If you do not want to go to the trouble of digging out information from your guides, I do have one global heresy that yet remains, one idea that pretty much everybody on this planet can agree is sacrosanct and untouchable, self-evident, divinely inspired, and given as a law/decreed/commandment of God. That idea is the idea of gender.

Let us think about this for a few moments? Everybody on this planet believes in the importance, nay

⁷⁷If you are scientist, there are a few sacred truths you could bounce yourself against (e.g. the myth of objectivity, the necessity of peer review, the superiority of the rational mind, things like that).

sacredness, of gender. Scientists, priests, popes, magi, pundits, politicians, a four year old child, and even the average Joe down in the pub find common ground here.

You cannot argue this point. Gender is held up as the quintessential feature of our identity. Gender is portrayed as the experiential root of our divine, sacred, existence. Gender is given as the evolutionary core of our biological heritage. Almost everybody believes that gender is the crux of our existential nature. Gender supersedes all other identity categories, even ethnicity. We define ourselves first and last, alpha and omega, beginning and when we finally end, by the configuration of our sacral chakra (i.e. our genital apparatus). Moreover, it is not just that we divide ourselves into genders, it is that “we” (and by “we” I mean System Agents) make a big deal of such a minor difference! Male or female, the difference between somebody with a penis and somebody with a vagina is, we are told, profound.

Indeed, for reasons that you will come to understand later, gender differentiation is so important that our belief in the power of gender is not left to chance. So, indoctrination begins at birth. The very first thing that babies get is a gender assignment. Boys get blue blankets, girls get pink, and it just gets worse from

there. The blatant, unabashed, bold-faced attempt to separate the genders continues on through infancy, childhood, adolescence, and even adulthood where everything from the clothes you wear to the games you play to the foods you eat are gender loaded with all sorts of “boys do this” and “girls do that” nonsense. For reason I will go into another time, we are taught literally from day one that gender is some kind of big fat sacred deal, and we bite it, hook, line, and sinker. By the age of four we ourselves begin to enforce gender boundaries, and by adolescence gender has become a defining category. By the time we are adults, gender has been *burned* into the neural pathways of our brains to the point where every breath of air we take is a gendered breath of air. Gender is so tightly imposed that it becomes a sacrilege/sin/heresy to step out of the boundary lines. My nine year old son is horrified at the thought of wearing pink, and ironically he didn’t get that from us. We hold no respect for gender boundaries in our home. He got it at school, from his teachers and peers.

But what’s the big deal anyway? When you consider the whole “gender” thing, you will notice that the similarities between males and females are far more significant than the differences. Both male and female have two arms, two legs, two eyes, a brain, and a central

nervous system. Both male and female have a physical unit that, aside from some minor psychological, emotional, and bodily differences (which are not as significant as they are made out to be), functions in an identical fashion. Nevertheless and despite the similarities, we make a big deal out of the whole gender thing. But I'll tell ya right now, from the perspective of Immortal Spirit, there ain't no big deal. In fact, allow me to be the first person to say to you that in the cosmic scheme of things, gender is irrelevant. The truth is, there are no deep mystical meanings, no esoteric secrets, no profound evolutionary significance, and no determining biological influences behind the sex of your physical vehicle. In the cosmic scheme of things, gender amounts to no more than a reproductive/survival strategy. It is relevant, but only on Earth, only in a human body, and only if you want to make a baby. In terms of Spirit/Consciousness/God/creation, **gender is nothing**. Please get this straight.⁷⁸ God/Consciousness is not gendered and there is no "Goddess" beyond which we, and be we I mean humans, create with our own conscious intent. The bottom line, Consciousness, god, spirit, soul has no sex. In the cosmic everything of our collective divinity, there is simply no room for gender,

⁷⁸Pun not intended.

and no reality behind its existence (other than what we, and by “we” I mean humans) give it.

Now, I know what you are thinking. I can hear the words you speak even before you speak them.

“Michael, can’t you see?” you will say.

“Male and female, positive and negative, yin and yang, electrons and protons, day and night...,” you will exclaim.

“Duality is everywhere!,” you shall recite.

“It is a sacred thing.”

“It is a cosmic thing.”

“Male and female are just another part of the grand cosmic design.”

“It is the way the universe works and the core of our cosmic being.” To that I say, nonsense. Consciousness is awareness pure and simple, and awareness is not gendered. Awareness is just awareness. Awareness has no gender at all, none, nada, zip.

“But Michael,” you say shaking your head, “electrons and protons, yin and yang, black and white, male and female, good and evil....”

“Can’t you see Mr. Michael,” the universe is a universe is opposites.”

But to that I say “blah, blah, blah, blah, blah.” Sure, gender is an aspect of creation, but only at the very “tip” of the unfolding universe, and only for a very limited purpose. Sex is relevant to the procreation of life, and that is all. Beyond that, you would be wise to put aside notions of gender altogether, and not just because, cosmologically speaking, its’ wrong, but also because the significance we attach to gender actually harms our ability to connect. The truth is, your physical unit is an electrical device and in order to function properly it needs to be properly wired. In order to properly wire your physical unit, you have to have both positive and negative, both yin and yang, flowing through the wires. Yin and yang are two sides of the same coin, two complementary aspects of the same **prana**, two sides of the same **chi**. A body uses yin *and* yang to maintain itself and create its world. Male or female, young or old, animal, vegetable or mineral, in this universe you must draw on both energies to function well. If you only draw one side of the energetic coin, something that you do if you overemphasize and identify with gender, you are not running at full potential. In fact, if you are only drawing on one energy, if you are only nurturing one aspect of yourself, you

cannot claim to be plugged in and turned on at all. If you do not have both positive and negative, if you do not have both yin and yang, if you do not nurture your “feminine” side *and* your “masculine” side, there is no electrical flow and no energetic movement. In creative terms, you are powered down, ineffective, and impotent.⁷⁹ The bottom line is that in order to bring power to your body, the animating consciousness must plug both negative and positive prongs into the cosmic receptacle. You need both yin and yang energies.

Now, I talk about fully empowering your body in more detail elsewhere. For now, I just want you to pay attention to the way you think and feel right. As you will realize, I just committed a heresy, and a big one. I told you that gender is irrelevant and went on and on about what a dumb and disempowering thing it is to believe in the gender binary. So, how did you react? Did you listen to what I was saying? Did you wonder if I was right? Or, did you get uptight and anxious? Did you gasp in incredulous disdain? Did you shake your head and

⁷⁹I suppose the creative impotence that comes from unbalanced energy flow might be one explanation for why indoctrination into gender binaries isn't left to chance. One of the things you have to do if you want to enslave people is make sure they do not achieve their full divine power. Corrupting energy flow through the manipulation of our ideas of gender is a very effective way of disconnecting and disempowering the human physical unit.

furrow your brows? Did your brain start spinning out denials? Did you struggle to maintain your emotional footing? Did you think about putting down the book? Did you deny, deny, deny? If so, you have a problem and that problem is, your mind is closed by elite dogma attached to your emotions. That is a big problem. If you are mentally and emotionally at a point where you cannot even open consider alternative ideas, your spiritual advancement will be curtailed. If your reaction was negative my advice to you is, chill. It is just words. Whether I am right or wrong about gender is something you can think about as you go. The point here is, keep an open mind and be prepared to commit a heresy, if necessary. Depending on where you are coming from and where you want to go, committing an uncomfortable heresy might be the only way for you to take that next step forward.

Nutrition, Exercise, and Rest

*When having a smackerel of
something with a friend, do not
eat so much that you get stuck in
the doorway trying to get out.
~Winnie-the-Pooh*

In closing this book I want to say a few things about diet, nutrition, and exercise. If you have not heard it before, you need to hear it now. What you put in your body, how you *fuel* your soul's physical vehicle, is important. Not only that, the amount of physical exercise you get is also critical. If you are going to be serious about this "spiritual awakening" thing, if you want to make best progress on this path of activation, if you want to stay healthy and attain full bodily power, you are going to have to pay close attention to the requirements of your physical unit for nutrition, exercise, and rest. As I emphasized earlier, connecting your two egos, awakening your body and mind, powering up, and driving safely on the roadways of creation is not about soul evolution or moral evolution or being a better child of God or declaring Jesus Christ

as your saviour or anything like that. Spiritual awakening is about bringing your full Consciousness, your spiritual ego, into your physical body and learning to use the physical vehicle properly. Basically, spiritual awakening is about turning on your engines, firing up your chakra systems,⁸⁰ and fine-tuning your physical body and mind enough to allow your soul, your higher self, your full Consciousness, a.k.a. the “divinity within,” full expression. More importantly, spiritual awakening is a *physical* process and as such, you have to treat it like any other physical process. If you want the physical process to work, you have to take care of it and fuel it properly. That means proper nutrition, proper exercise, and proper rest.

I do not want to spend a lot of time going into details. There is a lot of expertise out there already on these issues and you can tap into that expertise quite easily these days, so I’ll just say a few things on each topic, and make a few general comments, and leave it that. We will start with the requirement for exercise.

I do not think, or at least I hope, that there is not a single person reading this who does not understand the importance of exercise. From regular walking and

⁸⁰See Michael Sharp, *Book of Life: Ascension and the Divine World Order* and Michael Sharp, *Dossier of the Ascension: A Practical Guide to Chakra Activation and Kundalini Awakening*.

gentle aerobic exercise to strength training and plyometric exercises designed to develop your “fast twitch” muscles, regular exercise is important. I know that in the round of our overworked, stressful, filled-to-the-brim lives exercise is typically relegated to the bottom of the priority list, but if you want to maintain a healthy body and healthy mind, if you want to ensure longevity and healthy “old” age, you are going to have to put exercise at the top of your list. Generally, this will mean a minimum of three times a week of walking, strength development, and high intensity exercises. You do not have to spend a lot of time, even 20 minutes every couple of days is enough, but you do have to spend the time, and you do have to be reasonable about your expectations. If you are sitting there with four decades of couch potato life patterns weighing down on your waistline it is going to take you a while to change course, but you can do it. Start slow and gentle, but start just the same.

A good way to get into the swing of things is to consult the many fitness experts who make their training available for free online. There you can find everything from basic level training to more advanced physical regimes. You can also switch between programs as you get bored. Once again, it does not have to take a lot of time. Keep in mind also that if you are in an intimate

relationship, your partner will have to get involved as well. People can rarely sustain long-term interest in exercise programs if their significant other is not involved as well.

Finally on the topic of exercise, make sure you consult with your physician before you start any exercise program. Not even the advice of a qualified personal trainer should be taken out of context of the guidance from your family doctor. You can do more damage than good if you rush headlong into the game without taking proper precautions in advance.

Speaking of rushing headlong into the game, when you start your exercise program getting proper rest is going to become much more important. Rest is important so the body can regenerate, and this is especially true of people who are exercising, or even young children for that matter. We all need lots of sleep, but children and teenagers even more so. *Children need a lot of sleep because their bodies and brains are growing and teenagers need a lot of sleep because their brains and bodies are growing.* Children and teenagers suck in loads of energy during the day (through food, through breathing) and use that energy at night to transform and grow. You must give their growing bodies and minds the rest they need. Children need between 10

and 12 hours of rest each day, teenagers 12 or more. The sleep they get is critical. If your children aren't getting enough sleep, you are stunting their physical and mental growth. Indeed, *for the child's body and the teenager's mind, sleep trumps everything but breathing and eating*. In other words, sleep is more important than socialization, soccer, swimming, music lessons, or whatever else you do for your kids. Children need to go to bed early (especially if they wake up early) and teenagers should be allowed full sleep cycles, within parental reason.

Sleep is important for adults as well, not so much because we need the sleep to grow and develop but because it is during our sleep cycles that our bodies recover from the physical, social, political, psychological, and spiritual assaults we endure every day we exist within The System. Sleep is where a lot of the toxic negativity we experience during the day is washed away, and it is where your cells regenerate themselves. As a general principle, I would say that the uglier your day has been, the more sleep you'll need at night in order to recover. Personally, I would consider seven or eight hours as a minimum, but I would recommend more if you are doing any "heavy lifting," if you find yourself working in toxic environments, or if you feel you need the extra rest. A very few of us may

need less, but in general, we all benefit from nice long sleeps. Sleep is critical. If you are not getting enough sleep, you are not giving your body what it needs to recover, and if you do not give your body what it needs to recover, then over the short (and longer term) your body will weaken, sicken, and die, and that's no good.

There is a lot more that you can learn about exercise and rest and if you want to be able to take control of your own healing, awakening, and activation, you need to get out there and learn. With the Internet developed to the point it is these days, there aren't a lot of valid excuses for ignorance anymore. Still, there is a lot to learn and it does take time. Point yourself forward into a healthy future, begin making the changes you need to make, but do not kick yourself if the going is slow, especially at first. Not only is there a lot of change to accomplish individually, but there is a lot of collective change that has to happen as well. Until the day that we all put aside our driving need to work, work, work, until the economic system changes so that rest is actually something we can accomplish, and until it becomes illegal to sell toxic substances as food items, it is going to be an uphill battle for all of us.

Moving on from exercise and rest, it is also important to say, diet and nutrition are critical. If I could give you

one sentence of advice and make that stick it would be this: breathe properly, exercise, balance the energies, get rest, drive safely, and do not put toxic junk into your body, the temple of your spiritual ego. You would not put garbage in your car's gas tank would you? So why do you think it is appropriate to put junk in your body's tank? The question you have to ask yourself is, how the heck are your body and mind going to handle the intense vibration of your own high Consciousness if it is not fed and watered properly? The answer to that question, whether you like the answer or not, is that it is not. Bottom line, your body and mind (your physical unit) has to be strong and healthy to handle higher Consciousness. While it is true that your body is a finely tuned and self-balancing instrument of creation, it can only deal with so much. If you are going to feed it constant garbage, blithely ignore its nutritional requirements, and harass it with excessive drugs, alcohol, and sugar, it is not going to be able to properly handle/ground/express higher consciousness, and it is eventually going to break.

Remember this. What you put in your mouth goes to your brain, your CNS, and to the rest of your body. If you want your body and mind to work properly, put good fuel in, especially as you progress on the path. Proper diet is important at all times, but the farther we

get along in the process, the more people awaken, and the more of your own high Consciousness enters into your body and mind, the more important proper diet is going to be. As your Consciousness embraces the cells of your body, and as the energy levels of this planet continue to rise and finally skyrocket, your body and mind will do a lot better if you feed and water them properly. When you do, when you take care of them and keep them operating at peak efficiency, energy will flow, toxins will be released, cells will regenerate, and the entire fabric of your physical and mental existence will just work better.

Once again, there is a lot of fabulous nutritional expertise you can tap into these days, and since I'm no expert my advice to you is to tap into that expertise. Based on my own ongoing research, however, I think a few general statements can be offered on what a good diet looks like. Ideally, a good diet is one rich in low-fat protein and high nutritional value fruit, vegetables, nuts, sprouted grains, fermented foods, and smoothies. A good diet contains no processed foods whatsoever (or in extremely limited quantities) and few nutritionally empty white breads or pastas. Your body needs a certain amount of protein, and since our current commercial delivery system is set up to deliver protein via dead animal flesh, you may need to eat some

meat, but eating meat is not strictly necessary. However, you are far better off, both spiritually and physically, replacing protein provided by meat with protein derived from plant foods. Once again, consult a doctor, pay attention to your body, and make your own decisions.

In addition to increasing the quality and quantity of nutrition-rich foods (like sprouted grains and seeds, fermented vegetables, green smoothies, and so on), I also recommend you consider your intake of stimulants. The truth is, most of us work way too much and way too hard. We can only keep up the pace we keep because we fill our body full of stimulants. It used to be coffee was the primary culprit here, with its high levels of caffeine, but these days legalized amphetamines in the form of “energy drinks” can be named as well. You really need to evaluate your use of these substances, especially if your intake is high. True, there are some benefits to drinking coffee. It is high in antioxidants for example, but caffeine stimulates your CNS and prevents you from sleeping and resting, and in our over-drive global culture, that is bad. Couple the general lack of rest with the fact that you will need extra rest as you heal, exercise, awaken, and activate, and too much stimulation will only lead to accumulating sleep deficits. And this is not even to

mention a more spiritual concern which is that *too much stimulation undermines your ability to connect*. Stimulants like coffee muck around with your metabolism and speed up your chatty left brain processes, especially when consumed in quantity. Speeding up your mental processes can be a good thing if you are working in a left-brain, linear type job. However, it is a bad thing in terms of opening yourself up to spiritual realms. If you want to open that channel of yours wider than mere intuition, you need to consider calming your mental processes down. I am not talking about the kind of “still point of silence” stuff you get with some schools of meditation; however, I am talking about relaxing the body and slowing the mental flow down enough so you can access subtle realms of spiritual communication and connection.⁸¹ Coffee and other stimulants are antithetical to the type of relaxation and slow down that is required not only for

⁸¹In the context of neural stimulation and connection to the Fabric of Consciousness, you may also want to limit your time with all the various electronic devices that have found their way into the marketplace. Devices generate electromagnetic fields and these fields interfere with connection processes, especially when you stick them right up against your crown chakra. My advice to you is, resist the temptation to organize your life around a device. It won't be a major issue in the early stages of awakening and activation, but it will down the road.

bodily health, but for spiritual connection as well, so moderation of intake is required.

Before closing off this final chapter, I have two more things to say about alcohol and water. On the topic of alcohol, the advice on meat holds true here as well. A glass of wine occasionally is probably not going to harm you, but you are better off without it. At low doses alcohol relaxes you, lowers inhibitions, and helps you unwind. At higher doses, and perhaps with chronic use, alcohol stupefies and causes damage to your brain. What is worse, alcohol is highly addictive. Anybody with unresolved emotional or psychological issues from childhood, anybody with traumatic life experiences, anybody with unmet needs, anybody who is existing in toxic and painful life circumstances should avoid alcohol (and other addictive drugs) altogether. If these things are true for you, you will have enough to deal with without making alcohol an addictive, stupefying crutch. Alcohol is a caustic and dangerous substance and should be treated as such, especially if your concern is to increase the sensitivity of your physical unit in order to enhance connection and move towards spiritual experience. Too much alcohol and you will be working at cross-purposes to your own desire to open up.

Finally, I want to say just a few words about water and that is, drink lots of it. Water is an essential substance and your body requires sufficient quantities to function properly. This is going to be even more important as you begin to go through the connection process. Consciousness, vibration, your soul, your light, your higher self, whatever you want to call it, is bright and powerful, while the cells of your body (and your body includes your brain) are fragile and easily damaged by the intensity of your Consciousness. Think about X-rays for a moment. Compared to your Consciousness, X-rays are not a particularly potent form of energy. Even so, an X-ray can cause your body's cells to *pop* and fizzle. Imagine the strain that occurs as your Consciousness settles in and "fills up" your body! If you are not eating right, getting rest, and drinking lots of water, damage can be done. Therefore, my advice to you is this: as Consciousness begins to descend into your body, drink lots of water. Once again, determining quantity falls upon you. Everybody's needs are different. Your water intake will vary by body size, temperature, altitude, exercise levels, current health, the amount of sleep You are getting, the type of food You are eating (more toxic foods require more water to flush), and any previous cellular damage done. The Institute of Medicine advises roughly about 13 cups of

liquid a day for men and nine cups a day for women.⁸² Consider this your minimum daily intake and do not ignore this advice.

In closing, allow me to say I understand the radical diet changes I may be suggesting for some of you, and the shock you may be experiencing at the extent of change that I am saying is required. What can I say. I do not know what it is like in other parts of the world, but our average North American diet and lifestyle is about as toxic as you can get. In North America, we are literally poisoning ourselves with nutritionally void and heavily damaged processed foods. We do not sleep well, we do not drink enough water, we eat crap, and we fill up daily with chemical stimulants designed to keep us going despite the fact that our bodies are on the verge of breaking down. Is it any wonder that as we age we bloat up, dry up, crack up, and break down? However, it does not have to be that way. Indeed, it should not be that way. As many are already beginning to find out, our bodies can stay healthy and functioning well beyond the arbitrary checkpoints we follow as we travel through the life cycle. The truth is, your body and mind can stay healthy as long as you want, as long as you properly feed, water, and rest.

⁸²<https://www.mayoclinic.com/health/water/NU00283>

As far as the transition to a healthy diet goes, this does not have to be a dramatic transition. You can go slowly. Move from regular coffee to decaf or green tea. Add a piece of fruit in the morning and at lunch. Replace the meat on your sandwiches with tomatoes, guacamole, and sprouts occasionally. Drink more plain water without the additives (i.e. avoid pop, caffeine beverages, juices) and when you do drink other than water, drink pulp filled smoothies, herbal teas, and the like.

Baby steps are fine. Just set your intent to transition to a healthier lifestyle and diet and then make the right choices when they come your way. Keep your intent pure and persistent. Visualize a healthy body and mind and the transition to a healthier eating style will occur naturally, spontaneously, and with minimal effort. Even better, it will get easier over time as the world, gradually right now but more rapidly in a few years, aligns with Consciousness. Chefs all around the world are busy developing healthier eating styles, and even now, grocers, restaurants, and other food establishments are starting to provide healthier alternatives. These alternatives will only grow and become more visible as the old processed food empires transform or die and more of us make the choice to embrace healthy lifestyles and live long and productive lives.

It is true A new and healthier marketplace will shortly emerge and it will become easier and easier to make the right choices for your awakening, activating, and ascending physical unit.

July 17, 2021

About the Author

Michael is a Sociologist with a specialization in psychology, religion, occult studies, social inequality, scholarly communication, and critical theory. After a dramatic crown chakra opening caused him to question the materialist foundation of modern science, he began exploring the spiritual and mystical side of life. Recognizing early the presence of elitism and patriarchy in the world's religious and "secret" traditions, he and his life partner began creating a new, open system of spirituality and mysticism free of the opportunistic bias in "*old energy*" systems. The Lightning Path™ is the culmination of their research and work.

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